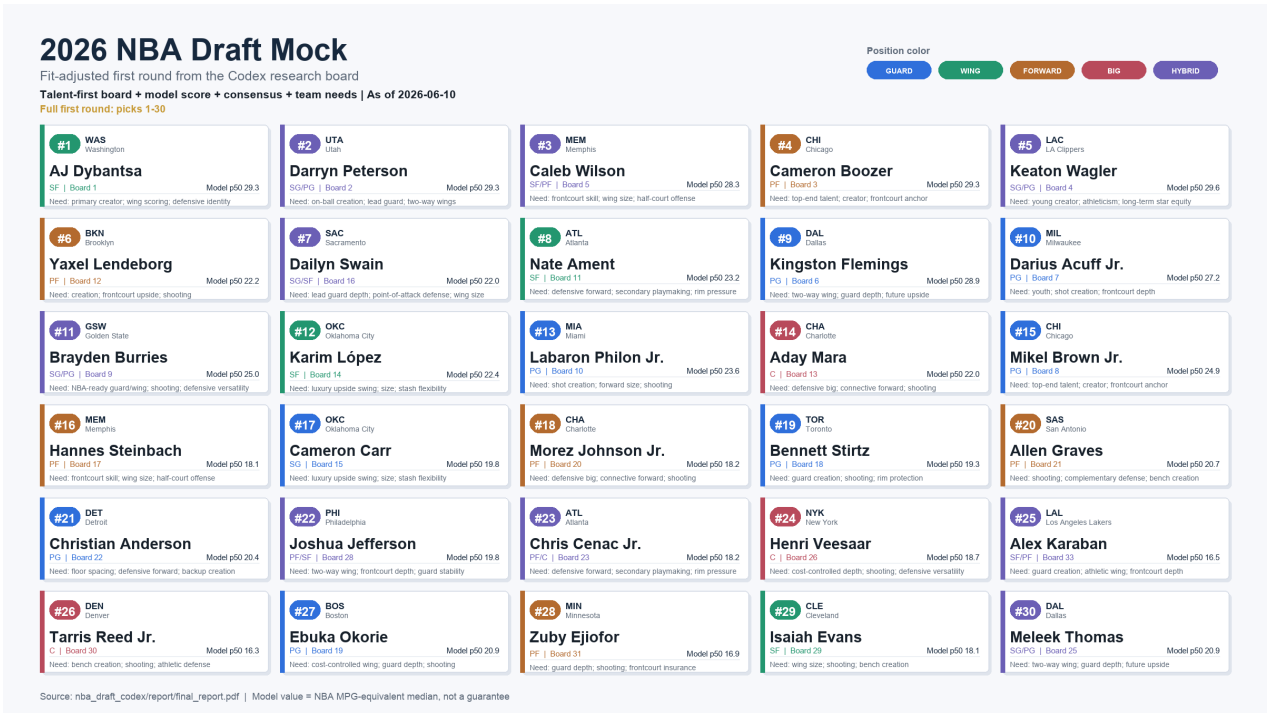


2026 NBA Draft Big Board

A LaTeX Research Report from the Codex Scouting Department

Current as of 2026-06-10 IST



Data, modeling, film-frame protocol, historical comps, and fit-adjusted mock draft

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1 Abstract

This report constructs a first-round 2026 NBA Draft big board from live public data collected on 2026-06-10. The final board is led by AJ Dybantsa, Darryn Peterson, Cameron Boozer. The project combines official first-round pick ownership, nine public ranking/mock signals, 2026 combine measurements where recoverable, season production, sourced scouting notes, still-frame film study, a historical draft dataset covering 2000-2021, leave-one-draft-class-out machine learning, bootstrapped uncertainty bands, nearest-neighbor historical comparisons, and team-fit context. The key modeling result is sober rather than flashy: market rank remains the strongest single predictor, and trait models improve the baseline only modestly. Therefore the final board uses a conservative blend of consensus rank, model median value, uncertainty, comps, and film/scouting context.

2 Introduction and Problem Statement

The assignment is not merely to list the first thirty prospects. The hard problem is evidence integration: a draft board should separate fetched facts from model inference, and it should distinguish a talent-first ranking from a fit-adjusted mock draft. The output therefore has two ranked artifacts. The big board ranks prospects by expected NBA value. The mock draft maps those prospects onto the actual first-round pick owners and broad roster needs.

This report is written like a Kaggle solution because the model is only useful if it is reproducible and benchmarked. It is written like an academic paper because the validity threats matter as much as the result. The 2026 class includes NCAA freshmen, older college producers, international prospects, and players with uneven samples. That mixture creates missing-data problems and translation-risk problems that should be visible to the reader.

3 Related Work and Prior Assumptions

Public draft models have repeatedly found that the market is difficult to beat. Draft slot and consensus rank capture a large amount of dispersed information: live scouting, medical intel, workouts, team interviews, and private measurements. Trait models can still help, especially when they identify statistical profiles that the market underprices, but a model that ignores consensus is likely to overfit. This project therefore treats market rank as the baseline to beat and as an input feature, not as an enemy.

The historical sources include public GitHub draft-model datasets, FiveThirtyEight historical projection data, draft-history/value tables, and combine measurement collections. These sources are imperfect but provide enough scale for a leave-one-draft-class-out validation design. The board also uses public scouting boards from Tankathon, Rookie Scale, CBS, Bleacher Report, Yahoo/KOC, The Ringer, and NBA Draft Room when the HTML snapshot exposed usable data.

4 Data Collection and Cleaning

All fetched live data and raw snapshots are logged under data/raw and sources.md. Processed tables live under data/processed. The draft order comes from NBA.com and is used only for the fit-adjusted mock draft; it does not change the pure big board. Prospect statistics primarily come from Tankathon and CBS snapshots. Combine measurements use the NBADraft.net Wayback snapshots plus NBA.com, On3,

Yahoo, and NBA Draft Room context where accessible. Several official NBA stats endpoints timed out and Basketball Reference bulk pages returned access blocks; those failures are carried into the limitations rather than hidden.

Source family	Logged entries
Official draft order	1
Current public boards/mocks	14
Combine and measurements	17
Historical modeling data	27
Film clips and frame archive	22
Failed/limited endpoints	7

4.1 Historical Dataset

The historical table contains 984 player-seasons/records from draft classes 2000 through 2021, including 520 first-round rows. Rows from 2000-2008 primarily come from the woodfin8 Draft Machine merged data. Rows from 2009-2021 use the JasonG NBA Draft Model data because it has richer pre-draft features and an NBA MPG proxy outcome. Career win shares and VORP are retained where present, but coverage is incomplete enough that the primary supervised target is NBA MPG-equivalent value.

Historical field	Non-null coverage
age_at_draft	62.1%
height_in	100.0%
weight_lbs	62.1%
wingspan_in	34.1%
standing_reach_in	34.1%
ts_pct	100.0%
usg_pct	60.9%
bpm	52.6%
outcome_mpg	100.0%
career_vorp	82.3%
career_ws	82.3%

4.2 Feature Families

The modeling matrix is intentionally broad but not exotic. Numeric features are: market_rank, age_at_draft, height_in, weight_lbs, wingspan_in, standing_reach_in, pts_per40, reb_per40, ast_per40, stl_per40, blk_per40, tov_per40, ts_pct, usg_pct, obpm, dbpm, bpm, ft_pct, three_pct, three_pa_per40. The categorical feature is position_group. For the comps engine, I used a narrower standardized vector: age_at_draft, height_in, weight_lbs, wingspan_in, pts_per40, reb_per40, ast_per40, stl_per40, blk_per40, ts_pct, usg_pct, bpm. Missing numeric values are median-imputed inside each training fold, and position_group is most-frequent imputed then one-hot encoded. This matters because several 2026 prospects have incomplete official combine or shooting fields.

4.3 Outcome Definitions

The regression target is `outcome_value`, defined as NBA MPG-equivalent value in the merged historical dataset. The tier classifier uses five ordered labels: bust, bench, rotation, starter, and star. The tier labels are not the ranking engine; they are probability-flavored context used to communicate floor and ceiling. The report does not claim that an MPG-equivalent model can fully summarize impact, defense, or playoff scalability.

5 Methodology

5.1 Consensus Aggregation

Player names are normalized across public boards. For every prospect, the pipeline computes source count, mean rank, median rank, minimum rank, maximum rank, and rank standard deviation. The standard deviation is treated as a risk signal: disagreement can indicate role uncertainty, medical uncertainty, sample-size uncertainty, or genuine upside/downside disagreement.

5.2 Machine Learning Models

The validation design is leave-one-draft-class-out. For each held-out draft year, every model is trained on all other years and evaluated on the held-out class. This avoids random-row leakage across eras and draft cohorts. The baseline is a ridge regression using only `market_rank`. The richer ridge model adds age, measurements, box-score rates, efficiency, usage, BPM components, shooting proxies, and position group. Nonlinear models are gradient boosting regression and random forest regression. A separate gradient boosting classifier predicts outcome tiers.

The specific model family choices are modest by design. Ridge provides interpretability and a strong regularized baseline. Gradient boosting captures nonlinear interactions such as age-by-production or size-by-role without requiring deep learning scale. Random forest is used as a robustness check. The bootstrap uncertainty band samples historical draft years with replacement and fits eighty shallow gradient boosting models; the reported p10/p50/p90 for 2026 prospects are percentiles of those bootstrap predictions.

5.3 Final Board Formula

Because the learned models only modestly beat the market baseline, the final board is a blended ranking rather than a pure model sort. The board score is:

$$S = 0.68(-z_{\text{consensus}}) + 0.27z_{\text{model}} - 0.05z_{\text{spread}}$$

where lower consensus rank is better, model is predicted p50 MPG-equivalent value, and spread is public-rank standard deviation. This weighting anchors the board to the strongest signal while still allowing model value and disagreement risk to move prospects within tiers.

5.4 Historical Comps Engine

The comps engine standardizes age, height, weight, wingspan, per-40 production, efficiency, usage, and BPM, then fits a five-nearest-neighbor model with Euclidean distance. Every comp cohort is empirical: the low, median, and high outcomes are the actual NBA MPG-equivalent outcomes of those historical neighbors. A comp is not claimed as a stylistic clone. It is a statistical-profile neighbor, and the report flags this distinction throughout.

6 Model Results

Model	MAE	RMSE	Spearman
Ridge baseline, market rank only	6.059	7.288	0.634
Ridge, market plus traits	5.966	7.220	0.644
Gradient boosting, market plus traits	5.963	7.329	0.621
Random forest, market plus traits	5.895	7.266	0.630

The market-only baseline posted MAE 6.059, RMSE 7.288, and Spearman 0.634. The random forest posted the best MAE at 5.895; ridge with traits posted the best rank correlation at 0.644. This is a narrow win, not a model landslide. The main conclusion is that model output is useful as a board modifier, but the public market remains the dominant prior.

6.1 Classifier

The tier classifier accuracy is 0.394. Its confusion matrix shows the expected draft-model problem: stars and busts are hard to separate from adjacent outcomes, and many true starters/rotation players collapse into the middle classes.

Actual	bust	bench	rotation	starter	star
bust	92	41	43	1	3
bench	57	61	107	13	0
rotation	24	62	190	34	5
starter	4	24	101	36	19
star	2	2	23	31	9

6.2 Feature Importance

Permutation importance confirms the central lesson. Market rank dominates. Secondary signals with meaningful but much smaller importance include assist production, age, turnovers, block/steal production, scoring volume, and shooting indicators. This aligns with the final-board design: a smart board can move from consensus, but it should not pretend that a small public feature set fully replaces the market.

Feature	Permutation MAE increase
market_rank	3.334
ast_per40	0.214
age_at_draft	0.093
tov_per40	0.089
blk_per40	0.089
pts_per40	0.083
three_pct	0.079
stl_per40	0.078
bpm	0.071
reb_per40	0.061
dbpm	0.051
height_in	0.046
three_pa_per40	0.046
obpm	0.040
ft_pct	0.028

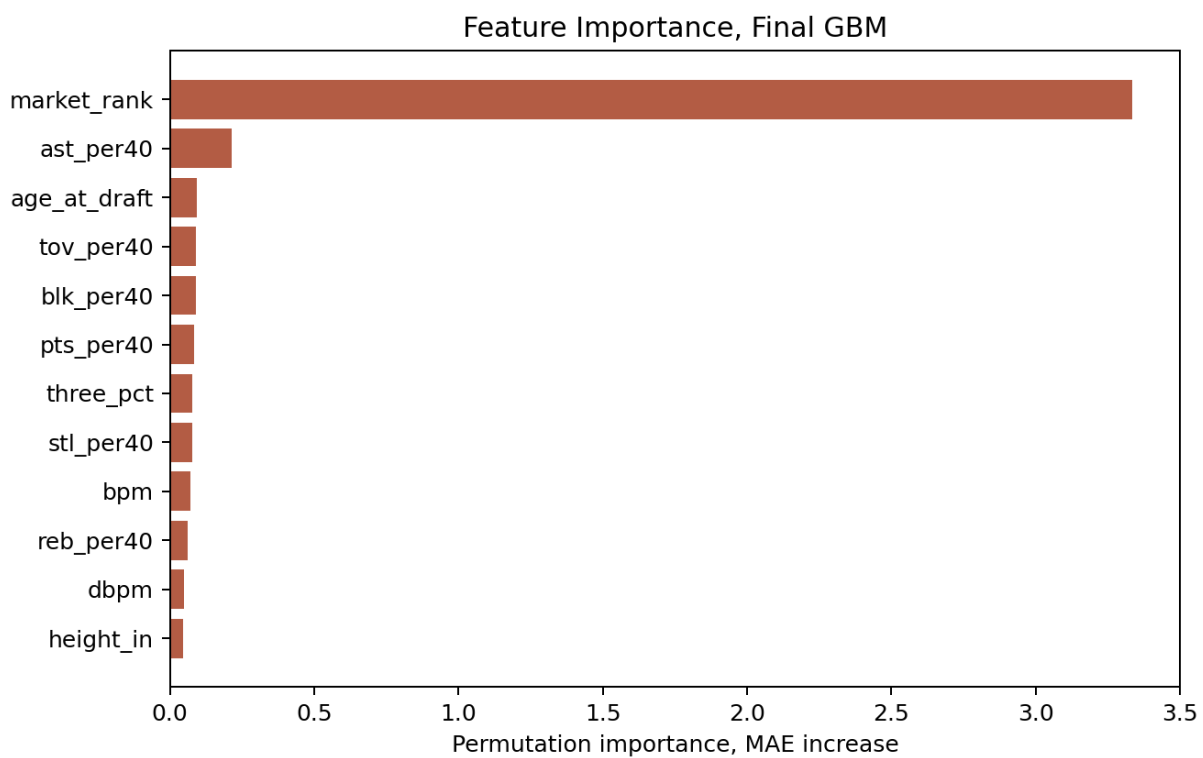


Figure 1: Permutation importance for the final gradient boosting model.

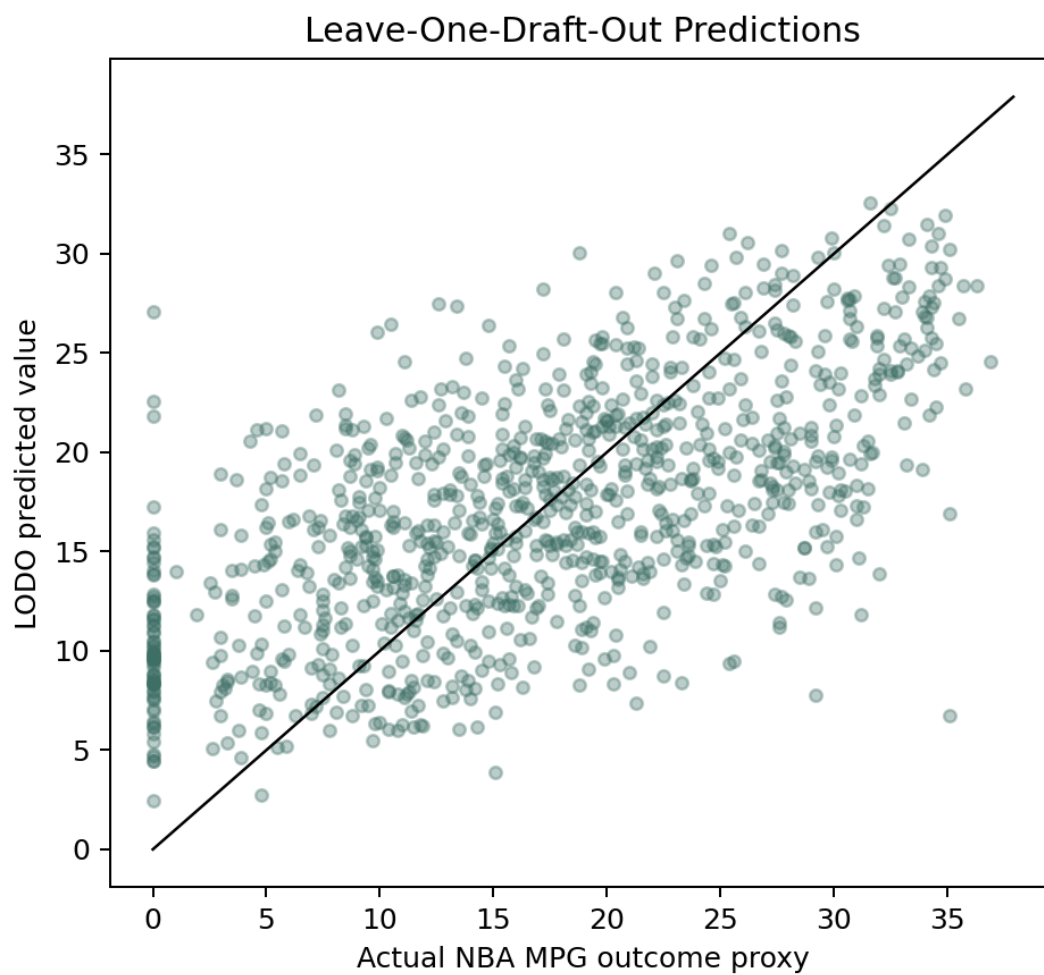


Figure 2: Leave-one-draft-class-out predictions versus actual NBA MPG-equivalent outcome.

7 Board-Level Figures

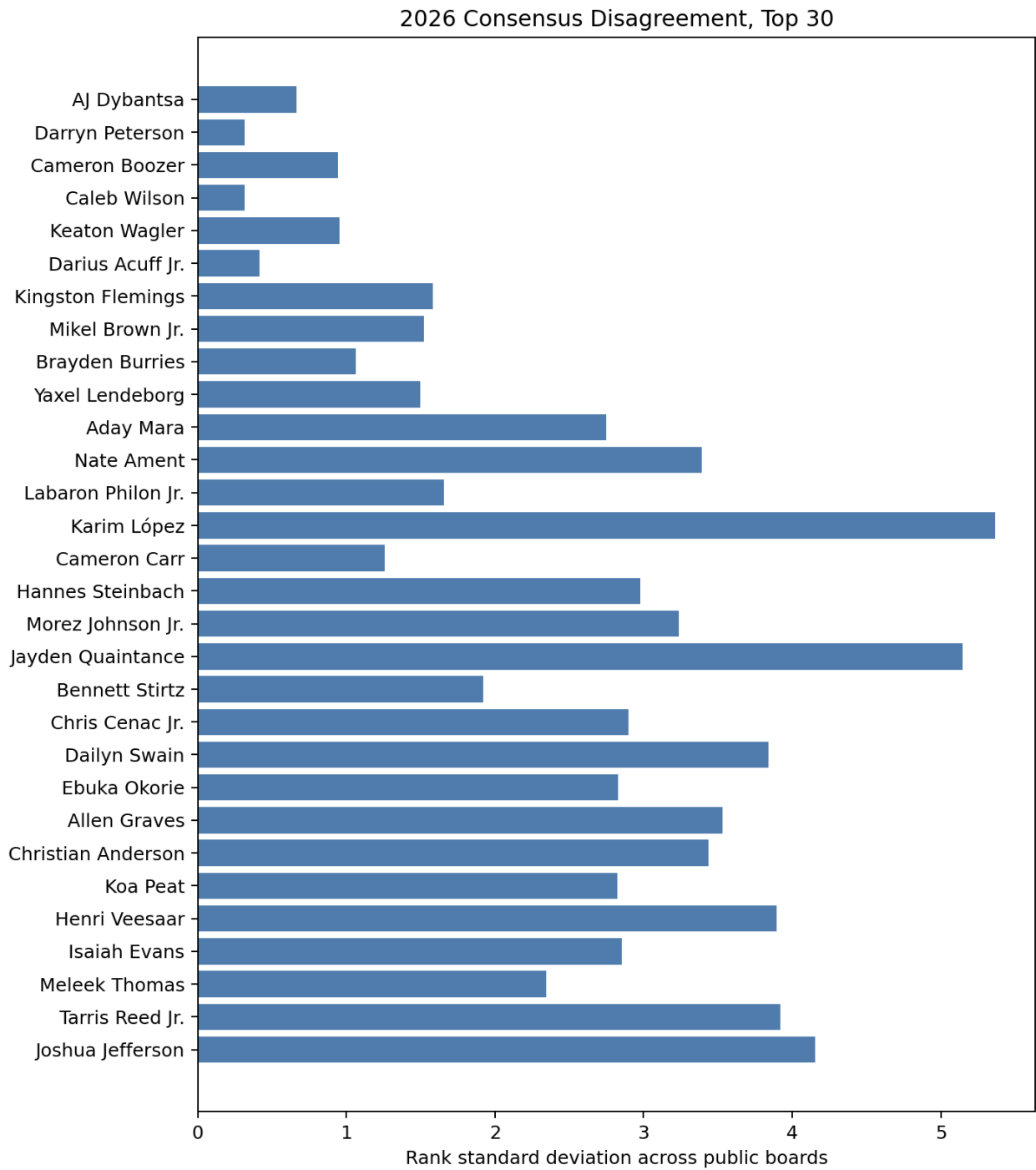


Figure 3: Public-board disagreement among top prospects. Spread is used as a risk feature.

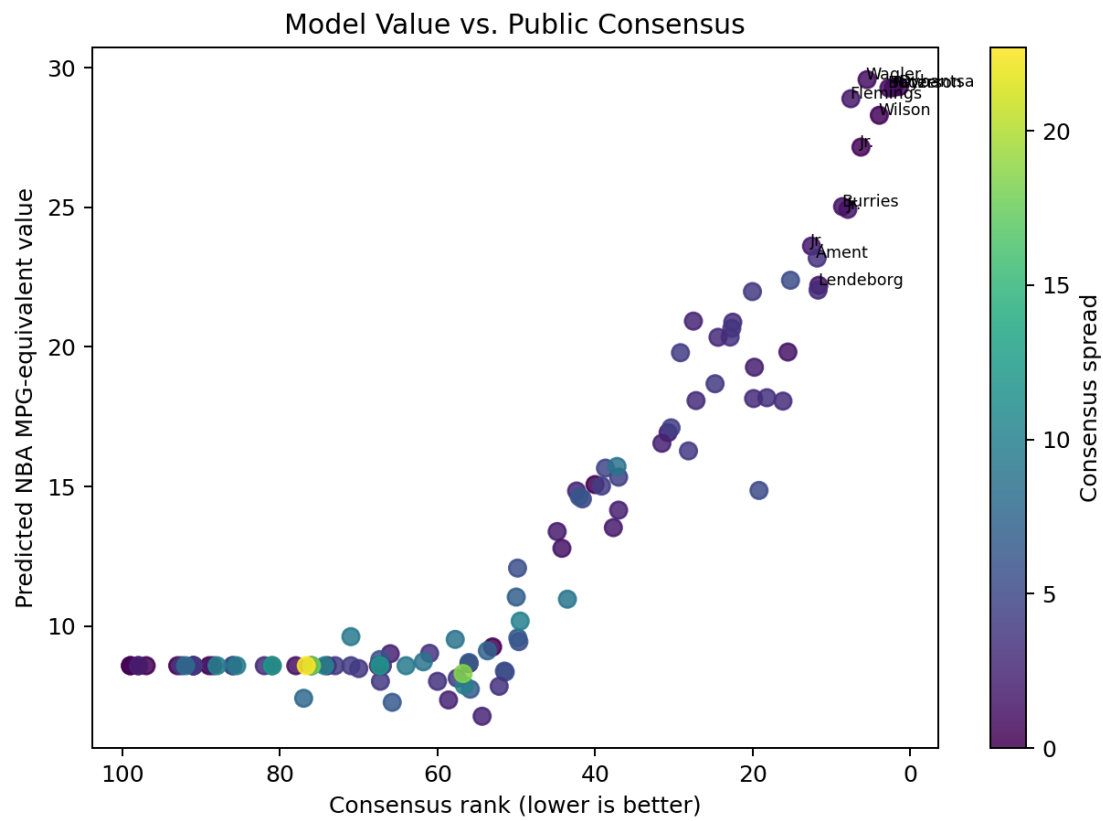


Figure 4: Model value versus consensus rank; color encodes consensus spread.

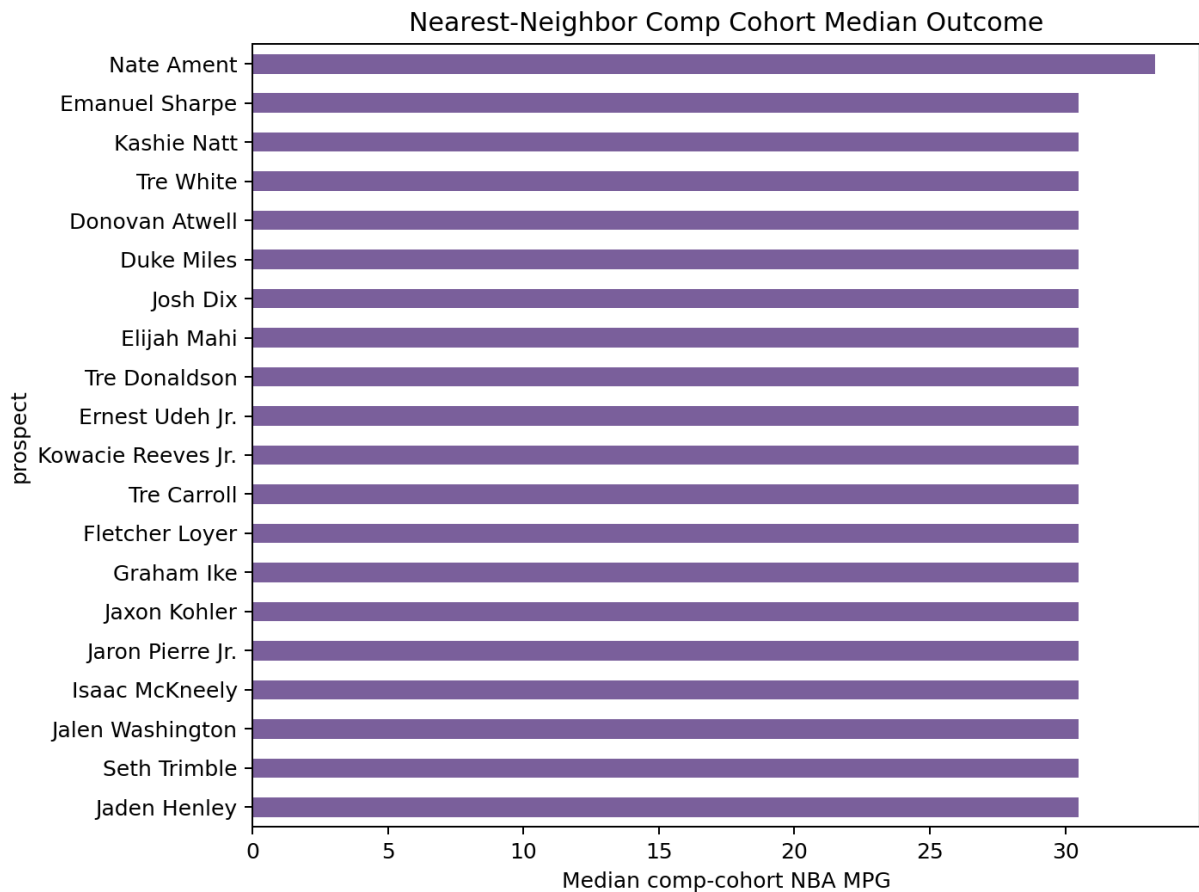


Figure 5: Median NBA MPG outcome of nearest-neighbor historical comp cohorts.

8 Film Study: Protocol and Representative Frames

The film component is intentionally conservative. Public clips were downloaded or imported through a local yt-dlp/ffmpeg archive, frames were sampled, and notes were written with two separate buckets: frame-based observations made from still images, and sourced human scouting observations. A still frame can support a claim about body position, release point, gather height, handle posture, or the presence of a contest. It cannot support a confident claim about burst, processing speed, screen navigation timing, defensive reaction time, or live advantage creation. Those claims remain sourced human-scouting context, not model evidence.

For the top ten, I selected up to four illustrative frames per prospect. They are included below as evidence examples, not as a substitute for full-game film charting.

8.1 AJ Dybantsa: selected still frames

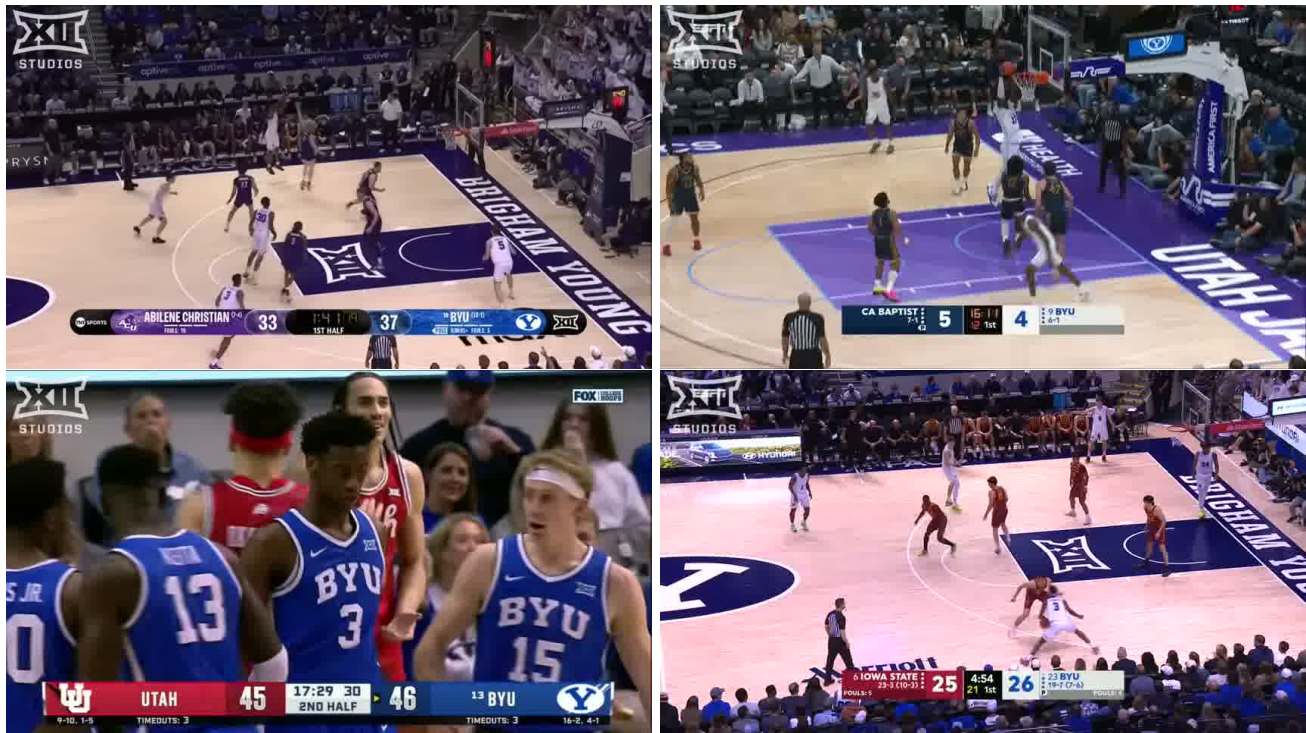


Figure 6: Selected frame samples for AJ Dybantsa. These images support only the static observations discussed in the notes.

8.2 Darryn Peterson: selected still frames



Figure 7: Selected frame samples for Darryn Peterson. These images support only the static observations discussed in the notes.

8.3 Cameron Boozer: selected still frames

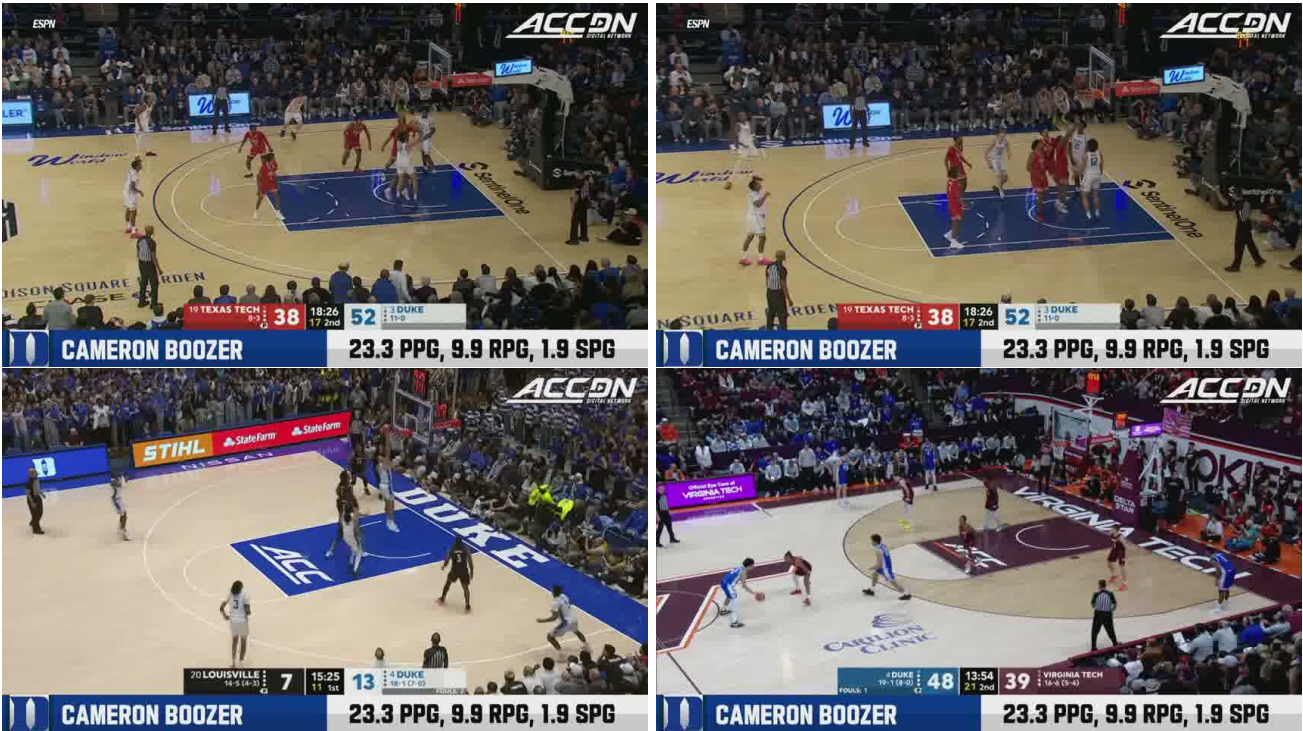


Figure 8: Selected frame samples for Cameron Boozer. These images support only the static observations discussed in the notes.

8.4 Keaton Wagler: selected still frames

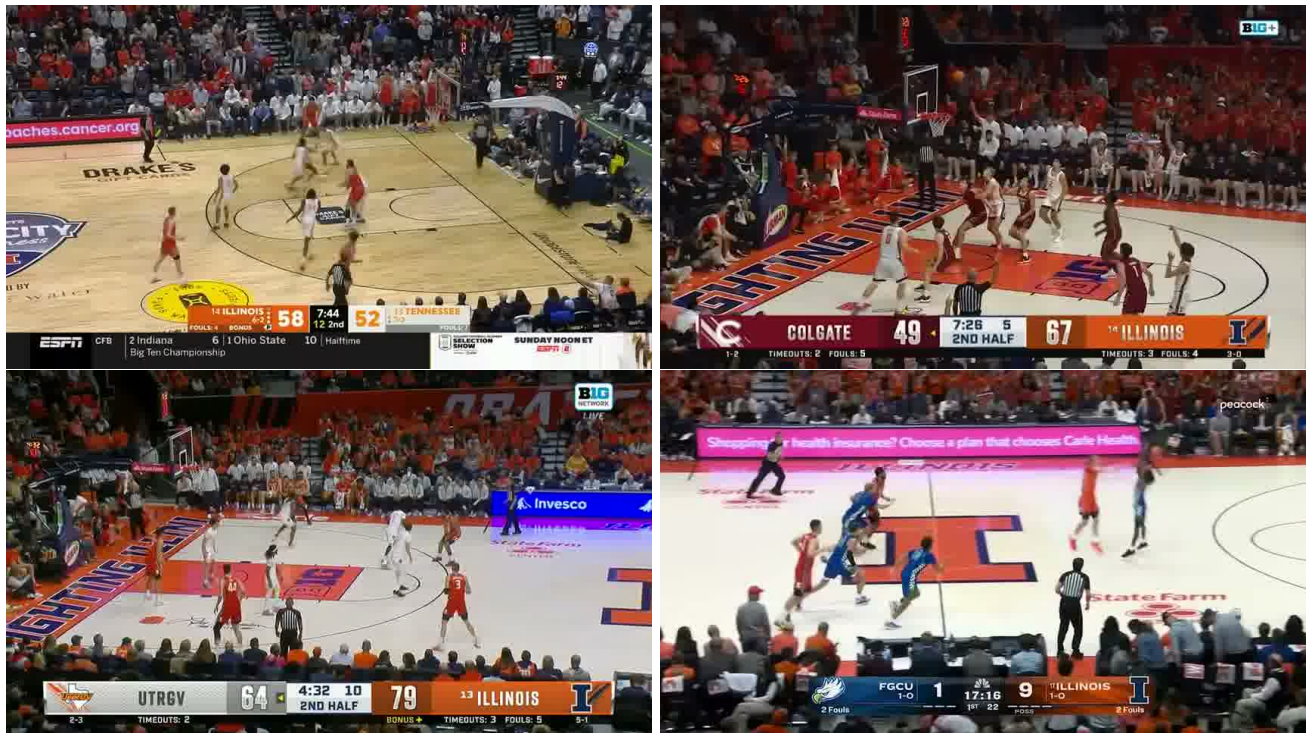


Figure 9: Selected frame samples for Keaton Wagler. These images support only the static observations discussed in the notes.

8.5 Caleb Wilson: selected still frames



Figure 10: Selected frame samples for Caleb Wilson. These images support only the static observations discussed in the notes.

8.6 Kingston Flemings: selected still frames



Figure 11: Selected frame samples for Kingston Flemings. These images support only the static observations discussed in the notes.

8.7 Darius Acuff Jr.: selected still frames

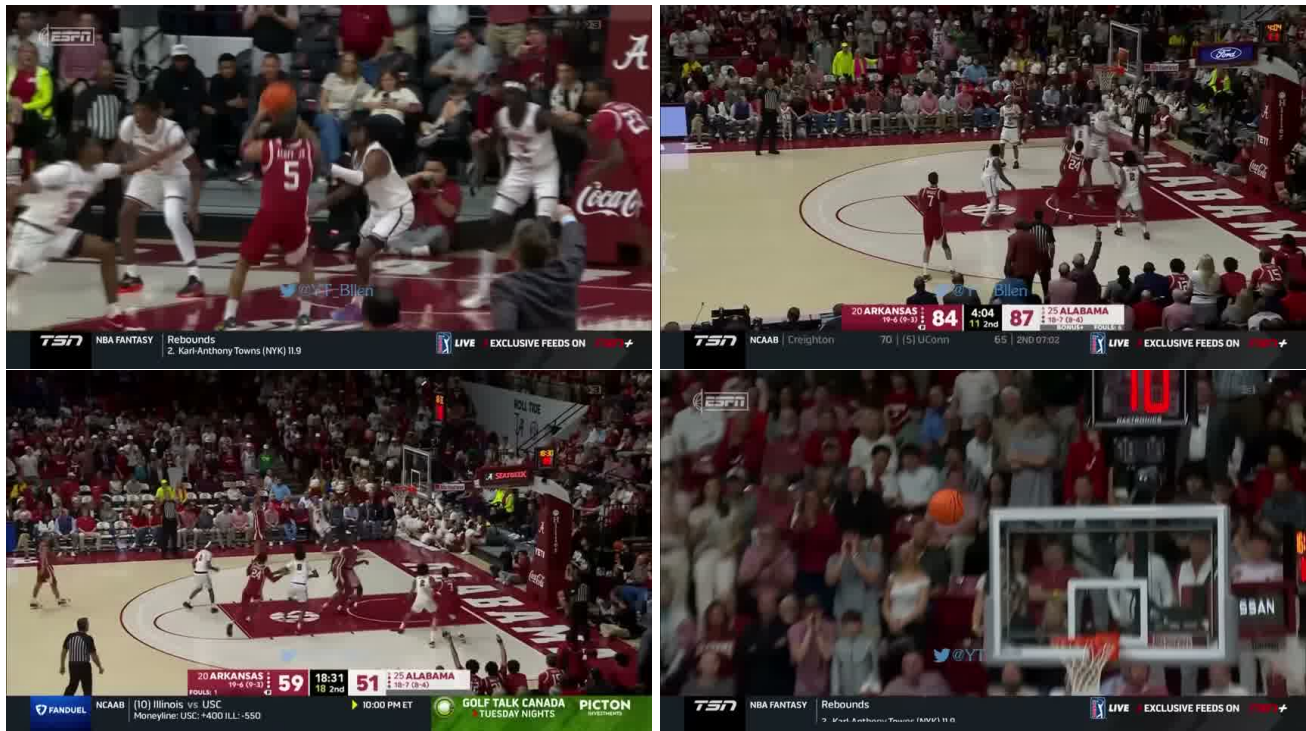


Figure 12: Selected frame samples for Darius Acuff Jr.. These images support only the static observations discussed in the notes.

8.8 Mikel Brown Jr.: selected still frames

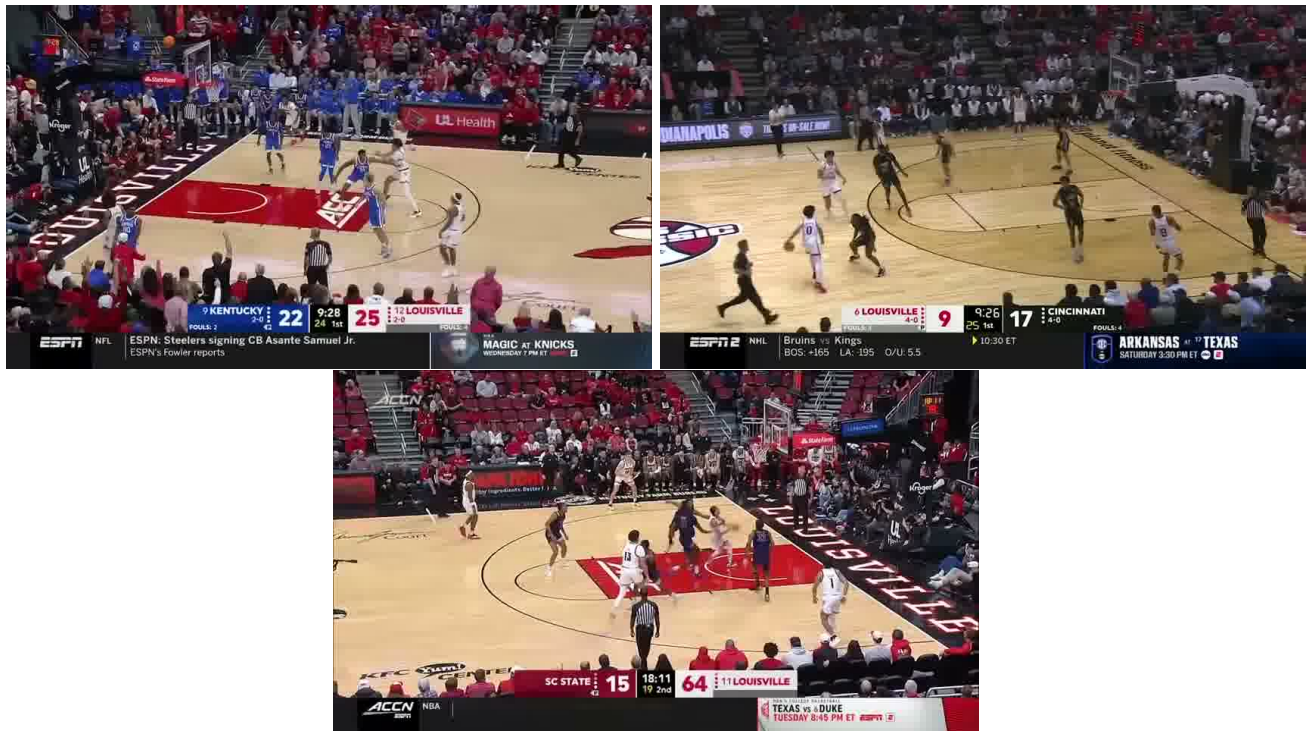


Figure 13: Selected frame samples for Mikel Brown Jr.. These images support only the static observations discussed in the notes.

8.9 Brayden Burries: selected still frames

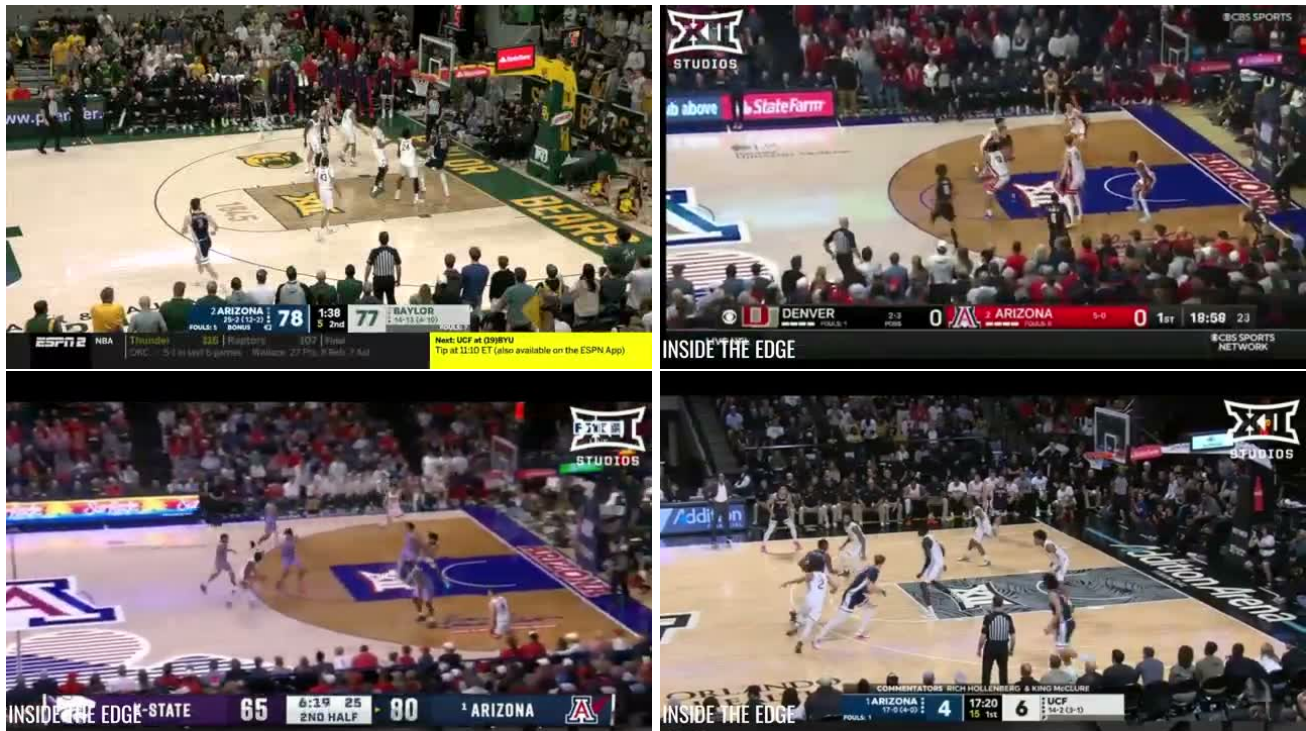


Figure 14: Selected frame samples for Brayden Burries. These images support only the static observations discussed in the notes.

8.10 Labaron Philon Jr.: selected still frames



Figure 15: Selected frame samples for Labaron Philon Jr.. These images support only the static observations discussed in the notes.

9 The 2026 Talent-First Big Board

The table below is the pure board. It is not a mock draft. The model value is an NBA MPG-equivalent median with a bootstrapped p10-p90 band, not a guaranteed minute projection.

Rank	Prospect	Pos	Team/School	Age	Consensus	Model p50 [p10,p90]	Tier
1	AJ Dybantsa	SF	BYU	19.4	1.3	29.3 [28.0, 31.4]	Tier 1: primary star bets
2	Darryn Peterson	SG/PG	Kansas	19.4	2.1	29.3 [27.6, 30.8]	Tier 1: primary star bets
3	Cameron Boozer	PF	Duke	18.9	2.7	29.3 [27.3, 30.7]	Tier 1: primary star bets
4	Keaton Wagler	SG/PG	Illinois	19.4	5.4	29.6 [28.5, 30.8]	Tier 2: high-lottery starters
5	Caleb Wilson	SF/PF	North Carolina	19.9	3.9	28.3 [26.9, 30.3]	Tier 2: high-lottery starters
6	Kingston Flemings	PG	Houston	19.5	7.5	28.9 [26.4, 30.7]	Tier 2: high-lottery starters
7	Darius Acuff Jr.	PG	Arkansas	19.6	6.2	27.2 [25.5, 29.1]	Tier 2: high-lottery starters
8	Mikel Brown Jr.	PG	Louisville	20.2	7.9	24.9 [23.2, 26.9]	Tier 2: high-lottery starters
9	Brayden Burries	SG/PG	Arizona	20.8	8.6	25.0 [23.2, 26.8]	Tier 3: starter/plus-rotation bets
10	Labaron Philon Jr.	PG	Alabama	20.6	12.5	23.6 [21.4, 25.1]	Tier 3: starter/plus-rotation bets
11	Nate Ament	SF	Tennessee	19.5	11.8	23.2 [21.8, 24.7]	Tier 3: starter/plus-rotation bets

Rank	Prospect	Pos	Team/School	Age	Consensus	Model p50 [p10,p90]	Tier
12	Yaxel Lendeborg	PF	Michigan	23.7	11.6	22.2 [20.7, 23.5]	Tier 3: starter/plus-rotation bets
13	Aday Mara	C	Michigan	21.2	11.7	22.0 [19.5, 25.1]	Tier 3: starter/plus-rotation bets
14	Karim López	SF	New Zealand	19.2	15.2	22.4 [20.7, 23.5]	Tier 3: starter/plus-rotation bets
15	Cameron Carr	SG	Baylor	21.6	15.5	19.8 [18.4, 21.3]	Tier 4: rotation upside
16	Dailyn Swain	SG/SF	Texas	20.9	20.0	22.0 [20.7, 23.4]	Tier 4: rotation upside
17	Hannes Steinbach	PF	Washington	20.1	16.1	18.1 [16.5, 20.2]	Tier 4: rotation upside
18	Bennett Stirtz	PG	Iowa	22.7	19.8	19.3 [17.9, 20.3]	Tier 4: rotation upside
19	Ebuka Okorie	PG	Stanford	19.2	22.5	20.9 [19.2, 22.9]	Tier 4: rotation upside
20	Morez Johnson Jr.	PF	Michigan	20.4	18.2	18.2 [16.7, 19.8]	Tier 4: rotation upside
21	Allen Graves	PF	Santa Clara	19.9	22.6	20.7 [17.7, 22.9]	Tier 4: rotation upside
22	Christian Anderson	PG	Texas Tech	20.2	22.8	20.4 [18.6, 22.0]	Tier 4: rotation upside
23	Chris Cenac Jr.	PF/C	Houston	19.4	19.9	18.2 [16.5, 19.7]	Tier 4: rotation upside
24	Koa Peat	PF	Arizona	19.4	24.4	20.3 [19.2, 21.4]	Tier 4: rotation upside
25	Meleek Thomas	SG/PG	Arkansas	19.9	27.5	20.9 [19.2, 22.5]	Tier 5: first-round value
26	Henri Veesaar	C	North Carolina	22.2	24.8	18.7 [17.2, 20.0]	Tier 5: first-round value
27	Jayden Quaintance	PF/C	Kentucky	18.9	19.2	14.9 [12.9, 17.5]	Tier 5: first-round value
28	Joshua Jefferson	PF/SF	Iowa State	22.6	29.1	19.8 [17.6, 21.3]	Tier 5: first-round value
29	Isaiah Evans	SF	Duke	20.5	27.2	18.1 [16.5, 19.1]	Tier 5: first-round value
30	Tarris Reed Jr.	C	UConn	22.9	28.1	16.3 [14.5, 18.7]	Tier 5: first-round value

9.1 1. AJ Dybantsa

Field	Value
Tier	Tier 1: primary star bets
Position / school	SF, BYU
Age at draft	19.4
Measurements	80.5 in, 217.0 lb, 84.5 in wingspan, 106.0 in reach
Production	25.5 PPG, 6.8 RPG, 3.7 APG, 1.1 SPG, 0.3 BPG
Efficiency / impact	TS 0.600, usage 33.9, BPM 11.7
Consensus	mean 1.3, median 1.0, spread 0.7, range 1-3
Model value	p10 28.0, p50 29.3, p90 31.4 MPG-equivalent
Tier probabilities	bust 2%, rotation 18%, starter 37%, star 40%

Ranking rationale.

- Codex rank is close to the public market, so the board treats this as an evidence-aligned slot rather than a strong contrarian call.
- The model median (29.3 MPG-equivalent) is comfortably above the 2026 prospect-pool median.
- Age at draft (19.4) is a positive developmental signal in this model family.
- Wingspan differential is positive at roughly +4.0 inches.

Nearest-neighbor comps.

#	Historical comp	Year	Pick	Outcome MPG	Tier
1	RJ Barrett	2019	3	33.3	star
2	TJ Warren	2014	14	27.4	starter
3	Jarrett Culver	2019	6	17.2	rotation
4	Alec Burks	2011	12	22.8	rotation
5	Cade Cunningham	2021	1	33.3	star

Frame-based film observations (mine).

- Jump shot, elevated release. On a left-wing jumper vs Abilene Christian (frame_0544.jpg, ball flight in frame_0547.jpg), the ball leaves above and slightly in front of his head with full arm extension at the top of the jump. The release point sits well above the closest defender's contest. Frames cannot show the rhythm or speed of the load, only that the...
- Free throw setup, squared and narrow-calm base (frame_0549.jpg, frame_0550.jpg, frame_0551.jpg). Close-ups at the line show shoulders level, eyes fixed on the rim, and a relaxed neutral posture before the dip. The broadcast framing crops the lower body, so base width at the line cannot be fully judged from these frames.

Sourced scouting cross-check. Human scouting sources consulted in the note file: Babcock Hoops scouting report, Deseret News, HoopsHype. I use these directionally and avoid treating still frames as live-film evidence.

9.2 2. Darryn Peterson

Field	Value
Tier	Tier 1: primary star bets
Position / school	SG/PG, Kansas
Age at draft	19.4
Measurements	76.5 in, 198.8 lb, 81.8 in wingspan, 103.0 in reach
Production	20.2 PPG, 4.2 RPG, 1.6 APG, 1.4 SPG, 0.6 BPG
Efficiency / impact	TS 0.578, usage 33.5, BPM 14.1
Consensus	mean 2.1, median 2.0, spread 0.3, range 2-3
Model value	p10 27.6, p50 29.3, p90 30.8 MPG-equivalent
Tier probabilities	bust 2%, rotation 19%, starter 52%, star 21%

Ranking rationale.

- Codex rank is close to the public market, so the board treats this as an evidence-aligned slot rather than a strong contrarian call.
- The model median (29.3 MPG-equivalent) is comfortably above the 2026 prospect-pool median.
- Age at draft (19.4) is a positive developmental signal in this model family.
- Wingspan differential is positive at roughly +5.2 inches.

Nearest-neighbor comps.

#	Historical comp	Year	Pick	Outcome MPG	Tier
1	Kentavious Caldwell-Pope	2013	8	29.6	starter
2	Jarrett Culver	2019	6	17.2	rotation
3	DAngelo Russell	2015	2	29.9	starter
4	TJ Warren	2014	14	27.4	starter
5	Klay Thompson	2011	11	32.8	starter

Frame-based film observations (mine).

- Pull-up sequence, drive to elevated release (frame_0057.jpg through frame_0061.jpg). He attacks right against K-State’s #10 with a low, forward-leaning drive posture (frame_0057, frame_0058), shields the ball on the gather with his shoulders turned into the defender (frame_0059), then rises into a pull-up with the ball above the rim line of the contesting...
- Second shooting motion, held follow-through (frame_0120.jpg, frame_0121.jpg). On a midrange jumper from the right elbow area, his shooting arm is still fully extended with a relaxed wrist a beat after the ball has left, elbow above eye level, suggesting a repeatable high-finish follow-through on this attempt. One-second sampling means the dip and set point...

Sourced scouting cross-check. Human scouting sources consulted in the note file: Babcock Hoops, HoopsHype, SI. I use these directionally and avoid treating still frames as live-film evidence.

9.3 3. Cameron Boozer

Field	Value
Tier	Tier 1: primary star bets
Position / school	PF, Duke
Age at draft	18.9
Measurements	80.2 in, 252.8 lb, 85.5 in wingspan, 108.0 in reach
Production	22.5 PPG, 10.2 RPG, 4.1 APG, 1.4 SPG, 0.6 BPG
Efficiency / impact	TS 0.653, usage 29.9, BPM 18.7
Consensus	mean 2.7, median 3.0, spread 0.9, range 1-4
Model value	p10 27.3, p50 29.3, p90 30.7 MPG-equivalent
Tier probabilities	bust 2%, rotation 19%, starter 43%, star 30%

Ranking rationale.

- Codex rank is close to the public market, so the board treats this as an evidence-aligned slot rather than a strong contrarian call.
- The model median (29.3 MPG-equivalent) is comfortably above the 2026 prospect-pool median.
- Age at draft (18.9) is a positive developmental signal in this model family.
- Wingspan differential is positive at roughly +5.2 inches.

Nearest-neighbor comps.

#	Historical comp	Year	Pick	Outcome MPG	Tier
1	Zion Williamson	2019	1	31.6	star
2	Derrick Williams	2011	2	20.7	rotation
3	Grant Williams	2019	22	21.8	rotation
4	Frank Kaminsky	2015	9	19.8	rotation
5	Jared Sullinger	2012	21	24.3	starter

Frame-based film observations (mine).

- Post-up into rim finish, two-frame rise (frame_0287.jpg through frame_0290.jpg, vs Texas Tech at MSG). He establishes a wide, low post seal on the right block with the defender pinned on his hip (frame_0289), then is airborne at the rim a frame later with the ball carried high and away from the swiping defender (frame_0290). Frames support a strong...
- Second finishing motion, full extension in traffic (frame_0562.jpg, frame_0563.jpg, vs Louisville). In a crowded paint he rises off two feet and reaches full arm extension above the rim line with his torso still vertical rather than drifting. The frames show body control and extension at the catch point of the play, not the takeoff speed.

Sourced scouting cross-check. Human scouting sources consulted in the note file: Babcock Hoops, CBS Sports, HoopsHype. I use these directionally and avoid treating still frames as live-film evidence.

9.4 4. Keaton Wagler

Field	Value
Tier	Tier 2: high-lottery starters
Position / school	SG/PG, Illinois
Age at draft	19.4
Measurements	77.0 in, 188.0 lb, 78.2 in wingspan, 100.0 in reach
Production	17.9 PPG, 5.1 RPG, 4.2 APG, 0.9 SPG, 0.4 BPG
Efficiency / impact	TS 0.596, usage 25.2, BPM 12.3
Consensus	mean 5.4, median 5.0, spread 1.0, range 5-8
Model value	p10 28.5, p50 29.6, p90 30.8 MPG-equivalent
Tier probabilities	bust 2%, rotation 15%, starter 56%, star 23%

Ranking rationale.

- Codex rank is close to the public market, so the board treats this as an evidence-aligned slot rather than a strong contrarian call.
- The model median (29.6 MPG-equivalent) is comfortably above the 2026 prospect-pool median.
- Age at draft (19.4) is a positive developmental signal in this model family.

Nearest-neighbor comps.

#	Historical comp	Year	Pick	Outcome MPG	Tier
1	Ben McLemore	2013	7	22.5	rotation
2	Luke Kennard	2017	12	23.3	rotation
3	Gary Harris	2014	19	28.1	starter
4	Devin Booker	2015	13	33.9	starter
5	Nik Stauskas	2014	8	19.5	rotation

Frame-based film observations (mine).

- Right-wing drive sequence vs Texas Tech (frame_0221.jpg through frame_0226.jpg). He receives on the right wing (frame_0221, frame_0222), attacks with the ball on his outside hand and his chest up rather than hunched (frame_0223), and works into the lane as three defenders converge (frame_0224, frame_0225); a white-jersey Illinois player is rising near the...
- Handle posture, low crouch on the left wing vs FGCU (frame_0259.jpg). In red #23 he sits in a deep knee bend with a flat back and the ball kept low on his outside hip, away from the digging defender. Frames support the posture only, not his change-of-pace or separation quickness.

Sourced scouting cross-check. Human scouting sources consulted in the note file: Babcock Hoops, Bleacher Report, FanSided. I use these directionally and avoid treating still frames as live-film evidence.

9.5 5. Caleb Wilson

Field	Value
Tier	Tier 2: high-lottery starters
Position / school	SF/PF, North Carolina
Age at draft	19.9
Measurements	81.2 in, 210.8 lb, 84.2 in wingspan, 108.0 in reach
Production	19.8 PPG, 9.4 RPG, 2.7 APG, 1.5 SPG, 1.4 BPG
Efficiency / impact	TS 0.626, usage 28.7, BPM 14.0
Consensus	mean 3.9, median 4.0, spread 0.3, range 3-4
Model value	p10 26.9, p50 28.3, p90 30.3 MPG-equivalent
Tier probabilities	bust 2%, rotation 22%, starter 35%, star 37%

Ranking rationale.

- Codex rank is close to the public market, so the board treats this as an evidence-aligned slot rather than a strong contrarian call.
- The model median (28.3 MPG-equivalent) is comfortably above the 2026 prospect-pool median.
- Age at draft (19.9) is a positive developmental signal in this model family.
- Wingspan differential is positive at roughly +3.0 inches.

Nearest-neighbor comps.

#	Historical comp	Year	Pick	Outcome MPG	Tier
1	Grant Williams	2019	22	21.8	rotation
2	Cody Zeller	2013	4	21.2	rotation
3	Brice Johnson	2016	25	5.1	bust
4	Otto Porter	2013	3	25.4	starter
5	Marvin Bagley	2018	2	24.1	starter

Frame-based film observations (mine).

- Turnaround jumper over a rim protector, vs Kansas (frame_0060.jpg through frame_0064.jpg). He backs down Kansas freshman Flory Bidunga on the right block with a wide, low base and the ball kept away from the defender (frame_0060, frame_0061), then rises into a turnaround with the ball released above his head, shooting arm fully extended at the top...
- Face-up drive and finish, vs Georgetown (frame_0258.jpg through frame_0262.jpg). He catches near the foul-line area holding the ball high at his chest/chin away from the defender (frame_0258), attacks the lane with a forward-leaning posture (frame_0259), and elevates in the paint with the ball raised above the contest (frame_0260), play resolving at the rim...

Sourced scouting cross-check. Human scouting sources consulted in the note file: Babcock Hoops, Bleacher Report, SI. I use these directionally and avoid treating still frames as live-film evidence.

9.6 6. Kingston Flemings

Field	Value
Tier	Tier 2: high-lottery starters
Position / school	PG, Houston
Age at draft	19.5
Measurements	74.5 in, 183.4 lb, 75.5 in wingspan, 98.5 in reach
Production	16.1 PPG, 4.1 RPG, 5.2 APG, 1.5 SPG, 0.3 BPG
Efficiency / impact	TS 0.563, usage 26.0, BPM 12.6
Consensus	mean 7.5, median 7.0, spread 1.6, range 5-11
Model value	p10 26.4, p50 28.9, p90 30.7 MPG-equivalent
Tier probabilities	bust 1%, rotation 40%, starter 40%, star 13%

Ranking rationale.

- Codex rank is close to the public market, so the board treats this as an evidence-aligned slot rather than a strong contrarian call.
- The model median (28.9 MPG-equivalent) is comfortably above the 2026 prospect-pool median.
- Age at draft (19.5) is a positive developmental signal in this model family.

Nearest-neighbor comps.

#	Historical comp	Year	Pick	Outcome MPG	Tier
1	Trey Burke	2013	9	20.9	rotation
2	Gary Harris	2014	19	28.1	starter
3	Jonny Flynn	2009	6	22.9	rotation
4	Monte Morris	2017	51	25.6	starter
5	Kemba Walker	2011	9	33.1	star

Frame-based film observations (mine).

- Body frame/build: the broadcast close-ups frame_0013.jpg, frame_0015.jpg (Texas Tech game, white #4) and frame_0253.jpg (Iowa State game, road black) show a visibly lean guard, narrow shoulders, thin arms, very little upper-body bulk. The jersey hangs loose off his frame in both games; he is one of the slighter-built players in any frame he shares.
- Isolation handle posture: in the Sweet 16 sequence frame_0195.jpg, frame_0196.jpg he sizes up Illinois' #2 at the top of the key with knees bent and the ball worked low and wide of his body on the crossover; his chest stays over his base rather than leaning back, and his eyes are up at the defender in 0196.

Sourced scouting cross-check. Human scouting sources consulted in the note file: <https://fansided.com>, <https://www.espn.com>. I use these directionally and avoid treating still frames as live-film evidence.

9.7 7. Darius Acuff Jr.

Field	Value
Tier	Tier 2: high-lottery starters
Position / school	PG, Arkansas
Age at draft	19.6
Measurements	74.0 in, 185.8 lb, 78.5 in wingspan, 98.5 in reach
Production	23.5 PPG, 3.1 RPG, 6.4 APG, 0.8 SPG, 0.3 BPG
Efficiency / impact	TS 0.604, usage 29.5, BPM 10.1
Consensus	mean 6.2, median 6.0, spread 0.4, range 6-7
Model value	p10 25.5, p50 27.2, p90 29.1 MPG-equivalent
Tier probabilities	bust 2%, rotation 24%, starter 54%, star 9%

Ranking rationale.

- Codex rank is close to the public market, so the board treats this as an evidence-aligned slot rather than a strong contrarian call.
- The model median (27.2 MPG-equivalent) is comfortably above the 2026 prospect-pool median.
- Age at draft (19.6) is a positive developmental signal in this model family.
- Wingspan differential is positive at roughly +4.5 inches.

Nearest-neighbor comps.

#	Historical comp	Year	Pick	Outcome MPG	Tier
1	Cameron Payne	2015	14	17.9	rotation
2	Willie Warren	2010	54	7.0	bust
3	Trey Burke	2013	9	20.9	rotation
4	Markelle Fultz	2017	1	26.2	starter
5	DAngelo Russell	2015	2	29.9	starter

Frame-based film observations (mine).

- Shooting gather/set point: on the baseline pull-up sequence (frame_0145.jpg, frame_0146.jpg, frame_0147.jpg, frame_0148.jpg) Acuff brings the ball up through the center of his chest to a set point at roughly forehead height before release. In frame_0147.jpg the ball sits just above eye level with elbow tucked under it and feet roughly shoulder width, and...
- Second shot sequence: frames frame_0108.jpg, frame_0109.jpg, frame_0110.jpg, frame_0111.jpg, frame_0112.jpg capture a possession ending in a jumper. In frame_0110.jpg he is gathered with the ball brought to the chest in traffic near the wing; frame_0112.jpg shows the ball in flight on a high trajectory. Motion blur in 0111 limits what can be said about the...

Sourced scouting cross-check. Human scouting sources consulted in the note file: <https://floorandceiling>, <https://sactownsports>, <https://www>. I use these directionally and avoid treating still frames as live-film evidence.

9.8 8. Mikel Brown Jr.

Field	Value
Tier	Tier 2: high-lottery starters
Position / school	PG, Louisville
Age at draft	20.2
Measurements	75.5 in, 190.2 lb, 79.5 in wingspan, 100.5 in reach
Production	18.2 PPG, 3.3 RPG, 4.7 APG, 1.2 SPG, 0.1 BPG
Efficiency / impact	TS 0.577, usage 31.4, BPM 6.6
Consensus	mean 7.9, median 8.0, spread 1.5, range 5-10
Model value	p10 23.2, p50 24.9, p90 26.9 MPG-equivalent
Tier probabilities	bust 2%, rotation 26%, starter 55%, star 10%

Ranking rationale.

- Codex rank is close to the public market, so the board treats this as an evidence-aligned slot rather than a strong contrarian call.
- The model median (24.9 MPG-equivalent) is comfortably above the 2026 prospect-pool median.
- Wingspan differential is positive at roughly +4.0 inches.

Nearest-neighbor comps.

#	Historical comp	Year	Pick	Outcome MPG	Tier
1	Collin Sexton	2018	8	30.2	starter
2	Elfrid Payton	2014	10	26.8	starter
3	Willie Warren	2010	54	7.0	bust
4	Saben Lee	2020	38	15.1	rotation
5	Jordan Crawford	2010	27	24.4	starter

Frame-based film observations (mine).

- Pull-up shooting motion vs Kentucky: in the run frame_0120.jpg, frame_0121.jpg, frame_0122.jpg, frame_0123.jpg Brown drives middle and rises into a pull-up. In frame_0122.jpg he is fully elevated with the ball released above his head, shooting arm extended toward the rim and legs nearly straight under him; the trailing defenders are still grounded, and his...
- Second shooting motion vs SC State: frames frame_0043.jpg, frame_0044.jpg, frame_0045.jpg, frame_0046.jpg show a drive from the wing into an elevated jumper in traffic. In frame_0046.jpg he is airborne in the lane with the ball at the top of the motion over multiple defenders, again with a high, above-the-head release rather than a push shot from the chest.

Sourced scouting cross-check. Human scouting sources consulted in the note file: <https://fansided.com>, <https://www.scout24.com>. I use these directionally and avoid treating still frames as live-film evidence.

9.9 9. Brayden Burries

Field	Value
Tier	Tier 3: starter/plus-rotation bets
Position / school	SG/PG, Arizona
Age at draft	20.8
Measurements	75.8 in, 215.4 lb, 78.0 in wingspan, 98.5 in reach
Production	16.1 PPG, 4.9 RPG, 2.4 APG, 1.5 SPG, 0.2 BPG
Efficiency / impact	TS 0.616, usage 23.2, BPM 11.7
Consensus	mean 8.6, median 9.0, spread 1.1, range 6-10
Model value	p10 23.2, p50 25.0, p90 26.8 MPG-equivalent
Tier probabilities	bust 3%, rotation 29%, starter 38%, star 23%

Ranking rationale.

- Codex rank is close to the public market, so the board treats this as an evidence-aligned slot rather than a strong contrarian call.
- The model median (25.0 MPG-equivalent) is comfortably above the 2026 prospect-pool median.

Nearest-neighbor comps.

#	Historical comp	Year	Pick	Outcome MPG	Tier
1	Jimmy Butler	2011	30	33.2	star
2	Luke Kennard	2017	12	23.3	rotation
3	Gary Harris	2014	19	28.1	starter
4	Ben McLemore	2013	7	22.5	rotation
5	Chase Budinger	2009	44	19.7	rotation

Frame-based film observations (mine).

- Transition three, vs Kansas (frame_0157.jpg through frame_0162.jpg). Arizona pushes off a stop (frame_0157, frame_0158), the featured guard arrives at the left wing/corner (frame_0159), and rises into a three with the ball released above his head and a Kansas defender closing late (frame_0160), then comes down with the ball already gone and the home crowd...
- Rim attack at Baylor (frame_0163.jpg through frame_0166.jpg). In a half-court set he works toward the paint (frame_0164, frame_0165) and frame_0166 shows him elevating in the lane through multiple Baylor defenders with the ball carried high. Supports a strong, body-first finishing posture in traffic; touch and timing fall between samples.

Sourced scouting cross-check. Human scouting sources consulted in the note file: Babcock Hoops, SI, Yahoo Sports. I use these directionally and avoid treating still frames as live-film evidence.

9.10 10. Labaron Philon Jr.

Field	Value
Tier	Tier 3: starter/plus-rotation bets
Position / school	PG, Alabama
Age at draft	20.6
Measurements	74.5 in, 176.2 lb, 78.2 in wingspan, 99.5 in reach
Production	22.0 PPG, 3.5 RPG, 5.0 APG, 1.2 SPG, 0.2 BPG
Efficiency / impact	TS 0.626, usage 30.0, BPM 11.3
Consensus	mean 12.5, median 13.0, spread 1.7, range 9-14
Model value	p10 21.4, p50 23.6, p90 25.1 MPG-equivalent
Tier probabilities	bust 3%, rotation 40%, starter 36%, star 4%

Ranking rationale.

- Codex is 2.5 slots above public mean rank because the blended board rewarded model value and/or comp outcomes more than the market did.
- The model median (23.6 MPG-equivalent) is comfortably above the 2026 prospect-pool median.
- Wingspan differential is positive at roughly +3.8 inches.

Nearest-neighbor comps.

#	Historical comp	Year	Pick	Outcome MPG	Tier
1	Erick Green	2013	46	8.7	bench
2	Damian Lillard	2012	6	36.3	star
3	Cameron Payne	2015	14	17.9	rotation
4	Nate Wolters	2013	38	18.7	rotation
5	Trey Burke	2013	9	20.9	rotation

Frame-based film observations (mine).

- Drive and finish at North Carolina (frame_0152.jpg through frame_0155.jpg). He receives in transition on the left wing with his body already low (frame_0152), splits two UNC defenders at the foul line off a low crossover with the ball kept tight to his hip (frame_0153), gathers through traffic at the restricted area (frame_0154), and the close-up in...
- Lane finish vs Arkansas State (frame_0186.jpg through frame_0189.jpg). He drives left into the lane with a deep knee bend and the ball dribbled low and outside his frame against the defender (frame_0187), elevates in the paint with the ball raised (frame_0188), and frame_0189 shows the Alabama bench with arms up as the play finishes. Supports a low...

Sourced scouting cross-check. Human scouting sources consulted in the note file: Babcock Hoops, Roundtable, Yahoo Sports. I use these directionally and avoid treating still frames as live-film evidence.

9.11 11. Nate Ament

Field	Value
Tier	Tier 3: starter/plus-rotation bets
Position / school	SF, Tennessee
Age at draft	19.5
Measurements	81.5 in, 210.8 lb, 83.5 in wingspan, 109.5 in reach
Production	16.7 PPG, 6.3 RPG, 2.3 APG, 1.0 SPG, 0.6 BPG
Efficiency / impact	TS 0.534, usage 29.0, BPM 8.4
Consensus	mean 11.8, median 10.0, spread 3.4, range 9-19
Model value	p10 21.8, p50 23.2, p90 24.7 MPG-equivalent
Tier probabilities	bust 4%, rotation 48%, starter 26%, star 9%

Ranking rationale.

- Codex rank is close to the public market, so the board treats this as an evidence-aligned slot rather than a strong contrarian call.
- The model median (23.2 MPG-equivalent) is comfortably above the 2026 prospect-pool median.
- Consensus spread is elevated (3.4 slots), which I treat as risk unless film/comps justify the upside.
- Age at draft (19.5) is a positive developmental signal in this model family.

Nearest-neighbor comps.

#	Historical comp	Year	Pick	Outcome MPG	Tier
1	Cade Cunningham	2021	1	33.3	star
2	Jayson Tatum	2017	3	34.1	starter
3	Andrew Wiggins	2014	1	34.4	starter
4	Tobias Harris	2011	19	31.6	starter
5	CJ Elleby	2020	46	15.5	rotation

Frame-based film observations (mine).

- Live-dribble crouch on the right wing vs Northern Kentucky (frame_0095.jpg). In white #1 he sits in a bent-knee crouch with a flat back and the ball on his right hand away from the defender, which is a notably low handling posture for a player listed 6'10". Frames support the posture, not his wiggle or separation quickness.
- Drive into a pull-up rise vs Northern Kentucky (frame_0096.jpg through frame_0099.jpg). He attacks middle off the wing (frame_0096, frame_0097), gets two feet into the lane (frame_0098), and in frame_0099 the white-jersey Tennessee shooter is airborne near the left elbow with the ball at a set point above his head and his torso vertical, releasing over the...

Sourced scouting cross-check. Human scouting sources consulted in the note file: Babcock Hoops, Floor & Ceiling, Sports Illustrated. I use these directionally and avoid treating still frames as live-film evidence.

9.12 12. Yaxel Lendeborg

Field	Value
Tier	Tier 3: starter/plus-rotation bets
Position / school	PF, Michigan
Age at draft	23.7
Measurements	80.8 in, 241.4 lb, 87.2 in wingspan, 108.5 in reach
Production	15.1 PPG, 6.8 RPG, 3.2 APG, 1.1 SPG, 1.2 BPG
Efficiency / impact	TS 0.646, usage 20.4, BPM 16.7
Consensus	mean 11.6, median 12.0, spread 1.5, range 8-13
Model value	p10 20.7, p50 22.2, p90 23.5 MPG-equivalent
Tier probabilities	bust 3%, rotation 64%, starter 17%, star 5%

Ranking rationale.

- Codex rank is close to the public market, so the board treats this as an evidence-aligned slot rather than a strong contrarian call.
- The model median (22.2 MPG-equivalent) is comfortably above the 2026 prospect-pool median.
- Age at draft (23.7) reduces long-horizon upside relative to younger peers.

- Wingspan differential is positive at roughly +6.5 inches.

Nearest-neighbor comps.

#	Historical comp	Year	Pick	Outcome MPG	Tier
1	Aaron White	2015	49	0.0	bust
2	Cameron Johnson	2019	11	25.4	starter
3	Erik Murphy	2013	49	2.6	bust
4	Frank Kaminsky	2015	9	19.8	rotation
5	Willie Cauley-Stein	2015	6	22.0	rotation

Frame-based film observations (mine).

- Mature, NBA-ready build in game context. Postgame close-ups show broad shoulders, thick arms, and a filled-out chest and trunk for a college forward; nothing about the frame reads underdeveloped. (frame_0016.jpg, frame_0060.jpg, frame_0070.jpg)
- Two-hand overhead finish under contact. In the Saint Louis clip he elevates with the ball secured in both hands above his head while a defender (#9) wraps him, keeping the ball high through the foul rather than bringing it down. (frame_0019.jpg, frame_0021.jpg, frame_0022.jpg)

Sourced scouting cross-check. Human scouting sources consulted in the note file: sports.yahoo.com, www.espn.com, x.com. I use these directionally and avoid treating still frames as live-film evidence.

9.13 13. Aday Mara

Field	Value
Tier	Tier 3: starter/plus-rotation bets
Position / school	C, Michigan
Age at draft	21.2
Measurements	87.0 in, 259.8 lb, 90.0 in wingspan, 117.0 in reach
Production	12.1 PPG, 6.8 RPG, 2.4 APG, 0.4 SPG, 2.6 BPG
Efficiency / impact	TS 0.659, usage 23.1, BPM 14.3
Consensus	mean 11.7, median 11.0, spread 2.7, range 8-18
Model value	p10 19.5, p50 22.0, p90 25.1 MPG-equivalent
Tier probabilities	bust 4%, rotation 37%, starter 12%, star 6%

Ranking rationale.

- Codex rank is close to the public market, so the board treats this as an evidence-aligned slot rather than a strong contrarian call.
- The model median (22.0 MPG-equivalent) is comfortably above the 2026 prospect-pool median.
- Wingspan differential is positive at roughly +3.0 inches.

Nearest-neighbor comps.

#	Historical comp	Year	Pick	Outcome MPG	Tier
1	Jakob Poeltl	2016	9	21.5	rotation
2	Karl-Anthony Towns	2015	1	34.0	star
3	Hasheem Thabeet	2009	2	10.5	bench
4	Udoka Azubuike	2020	27	8.9	bench
5	Chinanu Onuaku	2016	37	12.2	bench

Frame-based film observations (mine).

- High two-hand gather and overhead release near the rim. Mara secures the ball at full extension above the defense and releases close to backboard height with his right hand, elbow nearly locked out at release. Finishing extension is vertical rather than a sweeping hook. (frame_0059.jpg, frame_0060.jpg)
- Standing reach context. Standing flat-footed under the basket his head sits roughly at the bottom edge of the backboard, so set point on any close shot starts above typical contest height before he leaves the floor. (frame_0061.jpg)

Sourced scouting cross-check. Human scouting sources consulted in the note file: floorandceiling.substack.com, www.babcockhoops.com. I use these directionally and avoid treating still frames as live-film evidence.

9.14 14. Karim López

Field	Value
Tier	Tier 3: starter/plus-rotation bets
Position / school	SF, New Zealand
Age at draft	19.2
Measurements	80.2 in, 221.8 lb, 83.5 in wingspan, 105.5 in reach
Production	11.9 PPG, 6.1 RPG, 1.9 APG, 1.2 SPG, 1.0 BPG
Efficiency / impact	TS 0.580, usage 19.5, BPM NA
Consensus	mean 15.2, median 13.0, spread 5.4, range 11-27
Model value	p10 20.7, p50 22.4, p90 23.5 MPG-equivalent
Tier probabilities	bust 3%, rotation 41%, starter 31%, star 8%

Ranking rationale.

- Codex rank is close to the public market, so the board treats this as an evidence-aligned slot rather than a strong contrarian call.
- The model median (22.4 MPG-equivalent) is comfortably above the 2026 prospect-pool median.
- Consensus spread is elevated (5.4 slots), which I treat as risk unless film/comps justify the upside.
- Age at draft (19.2) is a positive developmental signal in this model family.
- Wingspan differential is positive at roughly +3.2 inches.

Nearest-neighbor comps.

#	Historical comp	Year	Pick	Outcome MPG	Tier
1	Michael Kidd-Gilchrist	2012	2	24.6	starter
2	Jonathan Isaac	2017	6	23.1	rotation
3	Justise Winslow	2015	10	25.9	starter
4	OG Anunoby	2017	23	29.0	starter
5	Moses Moody	2021	14	13.7	bench

Frame-based film observations (mine).

- Finishing extension on the move. He elevates off one foot and fully extends his right arm for a finger-roll style finish above the rim line, ball balanced one-handed at full reach with shoulders still mostly square. Length at the release point is obvious against NBL pros. (frame_0163.jpg, frame_0164.jpg, frame_0165.jpg, frame_0166.jpg)
- Downhill handle posture. Attacking in the open floor he pushes the ball ahead with his right hand, torso leaning into the drive, ball kept outside his frame away from the help defender rather than high and exposed. (frame_0163.jpg, frame_0164.jpg)

Sourced scouting cross-check. Human scouting sources consulted in the note file: floorandceiling.substack.com, www.babcockhoops.com. I use these directionally and avoid treating still frames as live-film evidence.

9.15 15. Cameron Carr

Field	Value
Tier	Tier 4: rotation upside
Position / school	SG, Baylor
Age at draft	21.6
Measurements	76.5 in, 184.4 lb, 84.8 in wingspan, 104.0 in reach
Production	18.9 PPG, 5.8 RPG, 2.6 APG, 0.9 SPG, 1.3 BPG
Efficiency / impact	TS 0.622, usage 25.3, BPM 9.2
Consensus	mean 15.5, median 15.0, spread 1.3, range 14-18
Model value	p10 18.4, p50 19.8, p90 21.3 MPG-equivalent
Tier probabilities	bust 4%, rotation 43%, starter 27%, star 5%

Ranking rationale.

- Codex rank is close to the public market, so the board treats this as an evidence-aligned slot rather than a strong contrarian call.
- The model median (19.8 MPG-equivalent) is comfortably above the 2026 prospect-pool median.
- Wingspan differential is positive at roughly +8.2 inches.

Nearest-neighbor comps.

#	Historical comp	Year	Pick	Outcome MPG	Tier
1	Allen Crabbe	2013	31	24.0	starter
2	Reggie Jackson	2011	24	25.4	starter
3	Will Barton	2012	40	25.2	starter
4	Immanuel Quickley	2020	25	24.5	starter
5	Morris Almond	2007	25	9.5	bench

Frame-based film observations (mine).

- Catch-and-shoot rep vs UTRGV (frame_0038.jpg, frame_0039.jpg). In frame_0038 he receives on the right side with feet already set and the ball coming up in one motion; in frame_0039 he is elevated with the ball at a set point above his forehead, elbow under the ball, releasing over a closing defender (#10) who is still beneath him. The frames support compact...
- Airborne full extension at the rim vs UTRGV (frame_0040.jpg). He is fully extended in the air with one arm at rim height and his body long and vertical as the bench and crowd rise behind him. The frame supports finishing extension in game context; it cannot show takeoff quickness or vertical pop directly.

Sourced scouting cross-check. Human scouting sources consulted in the note file: At The Hive, Babcock Hoops, Sports Illustrated. I use these directionally and avoid treating still frames as live-film evidence.

9.16 16. Dailyn Swain

Field	Value
Tier	Tier 4: rotation upside
Position / school	SG/SF, Texas
Age at draft	20.9
Measurements	78.5 in, 211.2 lb, 82.0 in wingspan, 104.5 in reach
Production	17.3 PPG, 7.5 RPG, 3.6 APG, 1.6 SPG, 0.3 BPG
Efficiency / impact	TS 0.636, usage 24.6, BPM 10.5
Consensus	mean 20.0, median 20.0, spread 3.8, range 13-25
Model value	p10 20.7, p50 22.0, p90 23.4 MPG-equivalent
Tier probabilities	bust 6%, rotation 41%, starter 33%, star 5%

Ranking rationale.

- Codex is 4.0 slots above public mean rank because the blended board rewarded model value and/or comp outcomes more than the market did.
- The model median (22.0 MPG-equivalent) is comfortably above the 2026 prospect-pool median.
- Consensus spread is elevated (3.8 slots), which I treat as risk unless film/comps justify the upside.
- Wingspan differential is positive at roughly +3.5 inches.

Nearest-neighbor comps.

#	Historical comp	Year	Pick	Outcome MPG	Tier
1	Kyle Korver	2003	51	25.4	starter
2	Luke Jackson	2004	10	9.9	bench
3	Mike Miller	2000	5	26.9	starter
4	Ryan Gomes	2005	50	27.6	starter
5	Reyshawn Terry	2007	44	0.0	bust

Frame-based film observations (mine). No completed frame note was available for this prospect; the board does not infer film traits from missing frames.

9.17 17. Hannes Steinbach

Field	Value
Tier	Tier 4: rotation upside
Position / school	PF, Washington
Age at draft	20.1
Measurements	82.2 in, 248.0 lb, 86.2 in wingspan, 108.0 in reach
Production	18.5 PPG, 11.8 RPG, 1.6 APG, 1.1 SPG, 1.2 BPG
Efficiency / impact	TS 0.636, usage 23.9, BPM 10.1
Consensus	mean 16.1, median 16.0, spread 3.0, range 10-21
Model value	p10 16.5, p50 18.1, p90 20.2 MPG-equivalent
Tier probabilities	bust 4%, rotation 52%, starter 19%, star 3%

Ranking rationale.

- Codex rank is close to the public market, so the board treats this as an evidence-aligned slot rather than a strong contrarian call.
- The model median (18.1 MPG-equivalent) is comfortably above the 2026 prospect-pool median.
- Wingspan differential is positive at roughly +4.0 inches.

Nearest-neighbor comps.

#	Historical comp	Year	Pick	Outcome MPG	Tier
1	Jakob Poeltl	2016	9	21.5	rotation
2	Bobby Portis	2015	22	22.4	rotation
3	Justin Patton	2017	16	13.4	bench
4	Domantas Sabonis	2016	11	29.9	starter
5	Zeke Nnaji	2020	22	12.6	bench

Frame-based film observations (mine).

- Body frame/build in game context. Steinbach (#6, dark "DAWGS" jersey) reads as a legitimately big, broad-shouldered 5 with a thick lower half; standing among Big Ten frontcourt players he is consistently one of the two tallest bodies on the floor, and his trunk looks filled out rather than stringy. [frame_0184.jpg, frame_0190.jpg, frame_0144.jpg]
- Finishing extension and gather, sequence one. On a left-block gather he keeps the ball high in a two-handed grip at roughly forehead height while a Wisconsin defender walls up, then extends into a high-release finish near the square with the ball above rim level, no dip back down into the crowd. [frame_0144.jpg, frame_0145.jpg, frame_0146.jpg...

Sourced scouting cross-check. Human scouting sources consulted in the note file: theswishtheory.com, www.babcockhoops.com, www.si.com. I use these directionally and avoid treating still frames as live-film evidence.

9.18 18. Bennett Stirtz

Field	Value
Tier	Tier 4: rotation upside
Position / school	PG, Iowa
Age at draft	22.7
Measurements	74.5 in, 186.2 lb, 78.0 in wingspan, 98.5 in reach
Production	19.8 PPG, 2.6 RPG, 4.4 APG, 1.4 SPG, 0.2 BPG
Efficiency / impact	TS 0.607, usage 26.9, BPM 10.2
Consensus	mean 19.8, median 19.5, spread 1.9, range 16-23
Model value	p10 17.9, p50 19.3, p90 20.3 MPG-equivalent
Tier probabilities	bust 5%, rotation 48%, starter 20%, star 2%

Ranking rationale.

- Codex rank is close to the public market, so the board treats this as an evidence-aligned slot rather than a strong contrarian call.
- The model median (19.3 MPG-equivalent) is comfortably above the 2026 prospect-pool median.
- Age at draft (22.7) reduces long-horizon upside relative to younger peers.
- Wingspan differential is positive at roughly +3.5 inches.

Nearest-neighbor comps.

#	Historical comp	Year	Pick	Outcome MPG	Tier
1	Tyshawn Taylor	2012	41	8.0	bench
2	Marcus Denmon	2012	59	0.0	bust
3	Toney Douglas	2009	29	19.1	rotation
4	Nolan Smith	2011	21	9.9	bench
5	Derrick White	2017	29	27.1	starter

Frame-based film observations (mine).

- Handle posture. On a live drive against an Ohio State defender he keeps the ball on a low right-hand dribble below knee height with his chest forward over the ball, shoulders level, and eyes up rather than down at the floor; the off-hand is up as a guard arm. [frame_0095.jpg, frame_0020.jpg]
- Shooting motion, sequence one (jumper, first half). Across consecutive frames he moves from a dribble into an elevated release near the free-throw-line-extended area, finishing at the top of his jump with both arms extended fully overhead and the shooting arm straight on the follow-through; teammates and the bench are already rising in the next frame. The...

Sourced scouting cross-check. Human scouting sources consulted in the note file: sports.yahoo.com, www.nbcsportsphiladelphia.com, www.peachtreehoops.com. I use these directionally and avoid treating still frames as live-film evidence.

9.19 19. Ebuka Okorie

Field	Value
Tier	Tier 4: rotation upside
Position / school	PG, Stanford
Age at draft	19.2
Measurements	73.2 in, 186.0 lb, 79.8 in wingspan, 98.0 in reach
Production	23.2 PPG, 3.6 RPG, 3.6 APG, 1.6 SPG, 0.3 BPG
Efficiency / impact	TS 0.589, usage 31.0, BPM 10.6
Consensus	mean 22.5, median 23.5, spread 2.8, range 16-26
Model value	p10 19.2, p50 20.9, p90 22.9 MPG-equivalent
Tier probabilities	bust 6%, rotation 35%, starter 36%, star 4%

Ranking rationale.

- Codex is 3.5 slots above public mean rank because the blended board rewarded model value and/or comp outcomes more than the market did.
- The model median (20.9 MPG-equivalent) is comfortably above the 2026 prospect-pool median.
- Age at draft (19.2) is a positive developmental signal in this model family.
- Wingspan differential is positive at roughly +6.5 inches.

Nearest-neighbor comps.

#	Historical comp	Year	Pick	Outcome MPG	Tier
1	DAngelo Russell	2015	2	29.9	starter
2	Markelle Fultz	2017	1	26.2	starter
3	Gary Harris	2014	19	28.1	starter

#	Historical comp	Year	Pick	Outcome MPG	Tier
4	Malik Monk	2017	11	21.3	rotation
5	Alec Burks	2011	12	22.8	rotation

Frame-based film observations (mine).

- Shooting motion, sequence one (game-winner at Virginia Tech). Across consecutive frames he rises into a pull-up from the left wing with the ball brought up in front of his face into a set point above his head, then a full one-arm follow-through with the wrist snapped while still airborne; his landing base looks balanced, feet under him, and the very next...
- Shooting motion, sequence two (vs Louisville at home). On a right-side catch he gets the ball overhead quickly into a compact, no-dip release; in the following frames the possession continues with him relocating, and the elevation again appears to come off a narrow but square base. [frame_0160.jpg, frame_0161.jpg, frame_0162.jpg, frame_0163.jpg]

Sourced scouting cross-check. Human scouting sources consulted in the note file: sports.yahoo.com, www.peachtreehoops.com, www.si.com. I use these directionally and avoid treating still frames as live-film evidence.

9.20 20. Morez Johnson Jr.

Field	Value
Tier	Tier 4: rotation upside
Position / school	PF, Michigan
Age at draft	20.4
Measurements	81.0 in, 250.6 lb, 87.5 in wingspan, 107.0 in reach
Production	13.1 PPG, 7.3 RPG, 1.2 APG, 0.7 SPG, 1.1 BPG
Efficiency / impact	TS 0.677, usage 21.3, BPM 11.8
Consensus	mean 18.2, median 17.0, spread 3.2, range 14-23
Model value	p10 16.7, p50 18.2, p90 19.8 MPG-equivalent
Tier probabilities	bust 4%, rotation 61%, starter 9%, star 2%

Ranking rationale.

- Codex rank is close to the public market, so the board treats this as an evidence-aligned slot rather than a strong contrarian call.
- The model median (18.2 MPG-equivalent) is comfortably above the 2026 prospect-pool median.
- Consensus spread is elevated (3.2 slots), which I treat as risk unless film/comps justify the upside.
- Wingspan differential is positive at roughly +6.5 inches.

Nearest-neighbor comps.

#	Historical comp	Year	Pick	Outcome MPG	Tier
1	Jakob Poeltl	2016	9	21.5	rotation
2	Justin Patton	2017	16	13.4	bench
3	Chinanu Onuaku	2016	37	12.2	bench
4	Bam Adebayo	2017	14	29.8	starter
5	Montrezl Harrell	2015	32	20.5	rotation

Frame-based film observations (mine).

- Body frame/build in game context. The close-up frame shows a genuinely wide, muscled shoulder girdle and thick arms with twists hair; in game frames the same build reads as a power big whose torso is noticeably denser than the wings around him. [frame_0035.jpg, frame_0012.jpg]
- Finishing extension, sequence one (vs Howard). The featured player drives the lane, gathers the ball low with two hands inside the dotted circle, then finishes above the rim with the ball arm fully extended over the front of the cylinder, hips squared to the backboard, off-arm tucked rather than flailing. [frame_0011.jpg, frame_0012.jpg, frame_0013.jpg...]

Sourced scouting cross-check. Human scouting sources consulted in the note file: floorandceiling.substack.com, www.babcockhoops.com, www.nbcsportsphiladelphia.com. I use these directionally and avoid treating still frames as live-film evidence.

9.21 21. Allen Graves

Field	Value
Tier	Tier 4: rotation upside
Position / school	PF, Santa Clara
Age at draft	19.9
Measurements	79.8 in, 225.6 lb, 84.0 in wingspan, 106.5 in reach
Production	11.8 PPG, 6.5 RPG, 1.8 APG, 1.9 SPG, 0.9 BPG
Efficiency / impact	TS 0.613, usage 21.9, BPM 13.4
Consensus	mean 22.6, median 23.0, spread 3.5, range 18-28
Model value	p10 17.7, p50 20.7, p90 22.9 MPG-equivalent
Tier probabilities	bust 6%, rotation 40%, starter 32%, star 7%

Ranking rationale.

- Codex rank is close to the public market, so the board treats this as an evidence-aligned slot rather than a strong contrarian call.
- The model median (20.7 MPG-equivalent) is comfortably above the 2026 prospect-pool median.
- Consensus spread is elevated (3.5 slots), which I treat as risk unless film/comps justify the upside.

- Age at draft (19.9) is a positive developmental signal in this model family.
- Wingspan differential is positive at roughly +4.2 inches.

Nearest-neighbor comps.

#	Historical comp	Year	Pick	Outcome MPG	Tier
1	Chuma Okeke	2019	16	22.2	rotation
2	Jae Crowder	2012	34	25.1	starter
3	Otto Porter	2013	3	25.4	starter
4	Victor Oladipo	2013	2	32.2	starter
5	Jordan Adams	2014	22	8.2	bench

Frame-based film observations (mine).

- Wing catch into a lane attack, vs Saint Mary's (frame_0497.jpg through frame_0499.jpg). The featured Bronco catches alone on the left wing in a ready stance with the ball held at chest height and knees already loaded (frame_0497), gets downhill against the Saint Mary's defense (frame_0498), and rises in the lane through contact with the ball protected high...
- Half-court scoring possession at Pacific (frame_0398.jpg through frame_0401.jpg). Consecutive seconds of a late-clock half-court set, with the featured player relocating along the lane line and presenting a target in the paint (frame_0400 shows him mid-lane with an arm extended upward at the foul-line area). The wide angle leaves it ambiguous whether...

Sourced scouting cross-check. Human scouting sources consulted in the note file: At The Hive, Babcock Hoops, Sports Business Classroom. I use these directionally and avoid treating still frames as live-film evidence.

9.22 22. Christian Anderson

Field	Value
Tier	Tier 4: rotation upside
Position / school	PG, Texas Tech
Age at draft	20.2
Measurements	72.8 in, 180.4 lb, 78.2 in wingspan, 96.5 in reach
Production	18.5 PPG, 3.6 RPG, 7.4 APG, 1.5 SPG, 0.2 BPG
Efficiency / impact	TS 0.626, usage 23.8, BPM 9.4
Consensus	mean 22.8, median 21.5, spread 3.4, range 19-28
Model value	p10 18.6, p50 20.4, p90 22.0 MPG-equivalent
Tier probabilities	bust 6%, rotation 33%, starter 34%, star 3%

Ranking rationale.

- Codex rank is close to the public market, so the board treats this as an evidence-aligned slot rather than a strong contrarian call.
- The model median (20.4 MPG-equivalent) is comfortably above the 2026 prospect-pool median.
- Consensus spread is elevated (3.4 slots), which I treat as risk unless film/comps justify the upside.
- Wingspan differential is positive at roughly +5.5 inches.

Nearest-neighbor comps.

#	Historical comp	Year	Pick	Outcome MPG	Tier
1	Jonny Flynn	2009	6	22.9	rotation
2	John Wall	2010	1	34.9	star
3	Jeff Teague	2009	19	26.8	starter
4	Darren Collison	2009	21	29.3	starter
5	Edmond Sumner	2017	52	14.0	bench

Frame-based film observations (mine). No completed frame note was available for this prospect; the board does not infer film traits from missing frames.

9.23 23. Chris Cenac Jr.

Field	Value
Tier	Tier 4: rotation upside
Position / school	PF/C, Houston
Age at draft	19.4
Measurements	82.2 in, 239.6 lb, 89.0 in wingspan, 108.5 in reach
Production	9.5 PPG, 7.9 RPG, 0.7 APG, 0.8 SPG, 0.5 BPG
Efficiency / impact	TS 0.546, usage 19.9, BPM 7.5
Consensus	mean 19.9, median 21.0, spread 2.9, range 15-23
Model value	p10 16.5, p50 18.2, p90 19.7 MPG-equivalent
Tier probabilities	bust 8%, rotation 31%, starter 19%, star 4%

Ranking rationale.

- Codex is 3.1 slots below public mean rank; the penalty comes from model uncertainty, weaker statistical translation, or higher disagreement risk.
- The model median (18.2 MPG-equivalent) is comfortably above the 2026 prospect-pool median.
- Age at draft (19.4) is a positive developmental signal in this model family.
- Wingspan differential is positive at roughly +6.8 inches.

Nearest-neighbor comps.

#	Historical comp	Year	Pick	Outcome MPG	Tier
1	Kevon Looney	2015	30	18.0	rotation
2	Tony Bradley	2017	28	11.1	bench
3	Trey Lyles	2015	12	18.2	rotation
4	Noah Vonleh	2014	9	16.2	rotation
5	Jarrett Allen	2017	22	27.8	starter

Frame-based film observations (mine). No completed frame note was available for this prospect; the board does not infer film traits from missing frames.

9.24 24. Koa Peat

Field	Value
Tier	Tier 4: rotation upside
Position / school	PF, Arizona
Age at draft	19.4
Measurements	79.0 in, 245.0 lb, 83.2 in wingspan, 104.0 in reach
Production	14.1 PPG, 5.6 RPG, 2.6 APG, 0.6 SPG, 0.7 BPG
Efficiency / impact	TS 0.557, usage 24.5, BPM 8.8
Consensus	mean 24.4, median 25.0, spread 2.8, range 18-27
Model value	p10 19.2, p50 20.3, p90 21.4 MPG-equivalent
Tier probabilities	bust 6%, rotation 38%, starter 30%, star 6%

Ranking rationale.

- Codex rank is close to the public market, so the board treats this as an evidence-aligned slot rather than a strong contrarian call.
- The model median (20.3 MPG-equivalent) is comfortably above the 2026 prospect-pool median.
- Age at draft (19.4) is a positive developmental signal in this model family.
- Wingspan differential is positive at roughly +4.2 inches.

Nearest-neighbor comps.

#	Historical comp	Year	Pick	Outcome MPG	Tier
1	Jeremiah Robinson-Earl	2021	32	19.2	rotation
2	Miles Bridges	2018	12	29.8	starter
3	Tobias Harris	2011	19	31.6	starter
4	Julius Randle	2014	7	32.0	starter
5	Ignas Brazdeikis	2019	47	13.1	bench

Frame-based film observations (mine). No completed frame note was available for this prospect; the board does not infer film traits from missing frames.

9.25 25. Meleek Thomas

Field	Value
Tier	Tier 5: first-round value
Position / school	SG/PG, Arkansas
Age at draft	19.9
Measurements	75.0 in, 189.6 lb, 78.8 in wingspan, 100.0 in reach
Production	15.6 PPG, 3.8 RPG, 2.5 APG, 1.5 SPG, 0.2 BPG
Efficiency / impact	TS 0.559, usage 23.6, BPM 7.0
Consensus	mean 27.5, median 28.0, spread 2.3, range 24-32
Model value	p10 19.2, p50 20.9, p90 22.5 MPG-equivalent
Tier probabilities	bust 5%, rotation 33%, starter 25%, star 5%

Ranking rationale.

- Codex is 2.5 slots above public mean rank because the blended board rewarded model value and/or comp outcomes more than the market did.
- The model median (20.9 MPG-equivalent) is comfortably above the 2026 prospect-pool median.
- Age at draft (19.9) is a positive developmental signal in this model family.
- Wingspan differential is positive at roughly +3.8 inches.

Nearest-neighbor comps.

#	Historical comp	Year	Pick	Outcome MPG	Tier
1	Malik Beasley	2016	19	22.6	rotation
2	Bradley Beal	2012	3	34.6	star
3	Gary Harris	2014	19	28.1	starter
4	Eric Bledsoe	2010	18	27.8	starter
5	Jared Cunningham	2012	24	7.2	bust

Frame-based film observations (mine). No completed frame note was available for this prospect; the board does not infer film traits from missing frames.

9.26 26. Henri Veesaar

Field	Value
Tier	Tier 5: first-round value
Position / school	C, North Carolina

Field	Value
Age at draft	22.2
Measurements	83.2 in, 227.2 lb, 86.0 in wingspan, 111.0 in reach
Production	17.0 PPG, 8.7 RPG, 2.1 APG, 0.6 SPG, 1.2 BPG
Efficiency / impact	TS 0.664, usage 23.3, BPM 10.7
Consensus	mean 24.8, median 25.0, spread 3.9, range 17-30
Model value	p10 17.2, p50 18.7, p90 20.0 MPG-equivalent
Tier probabilities	bust 7%, rotation 49%, starter 11%, star 3%

Ranking rationale.

- Codex rank is close to the public market, so the board treats this as an evidence-aligned slot rather than a strong contrarian call.
- The model median (18.7 MPG-equivalent) is comfortably above the 2026 prospect-pool median.
- Consensus spread is elevated (3.9 slots), which I treat as risk unless film/comps justify the upside.
- Age at draft (22.2) reduces long-horizon upside relative to younger peers.

Nearest-neighbor comps.

#	Historical comp	Year	Pick	Outcome MPG	Tier
1	Jakob Poeltl	2016	9	21.5	rotation
2	Justin Harper	2011	32	6.8	bust
3	Mason Plumlee	2013	22	22.6	rotation
4	Jeff Pendergraph	2009	31	9.8	bench
5	Tyler Zeller	2012	17	17.5	rotation

Frame-based film observations (mine). No completed frame note was available for this prospect; the board does not infer film traits from missing frames.

9.27 27. Jayden Quaintance

Field	Value
Tier	Tier 5: first-round value
Position / school	PF/C, Kentucky
Age at draft	18.9
Measurements	81.0 in, 253.4 lb, 89.2 in wingspan, 109.0 in reach
Production	5.0 PPG, 5.0 RPG, 0.5 APG, 0.5 SPG, 0.8 BPG
Efficiency / impact	TS 0.496, usage 19.2, BPM 1.9
Consensus	mean 19.2, median 18.0, spread 5.1, range 12-28
Model value	p10 12.9, p50 14.9, p90 17.5 MPG-equivalent
Tier probabilities	bust 4%, rotation 24%, starter 22%, star 3%

Ranking rationale.

- Codex is 7.8 slots below public mean rank; the penalty comes from model uncertainty, weaker statistical translation, or higher disagreement risk.
- The model median (14.9 MPG-equivalent) is comfortably above the 2026 prospect-pool median.
- Consensus spread is elevated (5.1 slots), which I treat as risk unless film/comps justify the upside.
- Age at draft (18.9) is a positive developmental signal in this model family.
- Wingspan differential is positive at roughly +8.2 inches.

Nearest-neighbor comps.

#	Historical comp	Year	Pick	Outcome MPG	Tier
1	Stephen Zimmerman	2016	41	5.7	bust
2	Ike Anigbogu	2017	47	2.6	bust
3	Harry Giles	2017	20	12.4	bench
4	Andre Drummond	2012	9	27.5	starter
5	Jarrett Allen	2017	22	27.8	starter

Frame-based film observations (mine). No completed frame note was available for this prospect; the board does not infer film traits from missing frames.

9.28 28. Joshua Jefferson

Field	Value
Tier	Tier 5: first-round value
Position / school	PF/SF, Iowa State
Age at draft	22.6
Measurements	79.8 in, 246.2 lb, 82.8 in wingspan, 104.5 in reach
Production	16.4 PPG, 7.4 RPG, 4.8 APG, 1.6 SPG, 0.8 BPG
Efficiency / impact	TS 0.560, usage 27.6, BPM 13.0
Consensus	mean 29.1, median 30.0, spread 4.2, range 20-33
Model value	p10 17.6, p50 19.8, p90 21.3 MPG-equivalent
Tier probabilities	bust 6%, rotation 37%, starter 25%, star 2%

Ranking rationale.

- Codex rank is close to the public market, so the board treats this as an evidence-aligned slot rather than a strong contrarian call.
- The model median (19.8 MPG-equivalent) is comfortably above the 2026 prospect-pool median.
- Consensus spread is elevated (4.2 slots), which I treat as risk unless film/comps justify the upside.
- Age at draft (22.6) reduces long-horizon upside relative to younger peers.

- Wingspan differential is positive at roughly +3.0 inches.

Nearest-neighbor comps.

#	Historical comp	Year	Pick	Outcome MPG	Tier
1	Draymond Green	2012	35	28.7	starter
2	Lamar Patterson	2014	48	10.9	bench
3	Desmond Bane	2020	30	28.9	starter
4	Josh Hart	2017	30	28.3	starter
5	Kris Dunn	2016	5	23.4	rotation

Frame-based film observations (mine). No completed frame note was available for this prospect; the board does not infer film traits from missing frames.

9.29 29. Isaiah Evans

Field	Value
Tier	Tier 5: first-round value
Position / school	SF, Duke
Age at draft	20.5
Measurements	77.5 in, 186.0 lb, 80.8 in wingspan, 104.5 in reach
Production	15.0 PPG, 3.2 RPG, 1.3 APG, 0.7 SPG, 0.7 BPG
Efficiency / impact	TS 0.590, usage 24.9, BPM 9.8
Consensus	mean 27.2, median 26.0, spread 2.9, range 24-33
Model value	p10 16.5, p50 18.1, p90 19.1 MPG-equivalent
Tier probabilities	bust 7%, rotation 42%, starter 21%, star 2%

Ranking rationale.

- Codex rank is close to the public market, so the board treats this as an evidence-aligned slot rather than a strong contrarian call.
- The model median (18.1 MPG-equivalent) is comfortably above the 2026 prospect-pool median.
- Wingspan differential is positive at roughly +3.2 inches.

Nearest-neighbor comps.

#	Historical comp	Year	Pick	Outcome MPG	Tier
1	Ben McLemore	2013	7	22.5	rotation
2	Jeremy Lamb	2012	12	20.8	rotation
3	Immanuel Quickley	2020	25	24.5	starter
4	Allen Crabbe	2013	31	24.0	starter

#	Historical comp	Year	Pick	Outcome MPG	Tier
5	Morris Almond	2007	25	9.5	bench

Frame-based film observations (mine). No completed frame note was available for this prospect; the board does not infer film traits from missing frames.

9.30 30. Tarris Reed Jr.

Field	Value
Tier	Tier 5: first-round value
Position / school	C, UConn
Age at draft	22.9
Measurements	81.8 in, 263.6 lb, 88.2 in wingspan, 110.0 in reach
Production	14.7 PPG, 9.0 RPG, 2.3 APG, 0.9 SPG, 2.0 BPG
Efficiency / impact	TS 0.614, usage 26.1, BPM 12.9
Consensus	mean 28.1, median 30.0, spread 3.9, range 20-32
Model value	p10 14.5, p50 16.3, p90 18.7 MPG-equivalent
Tier probabilities	bust 10%, rotation 50%, starter 12%, star 2%

Ranking rationale.

- Codex rank is close to the public market, so the board treats this as an evidence-aligned slot rather than a strong contrarian call.
- The model median (16.3 MPG-equivalent) is comfortably above the 2026 prospect-pool median.
- Consensus spread is elevated (3.9 slots), which I treat as risk unless film/comps justify the upside.
- Age at draft (22.9) reduces long-horizon upside relative to younger peers.
- Wingspan differential is positive at roughly +6.5 inches.

Nearest-neighbor comps.

#	Historical comp	Year	Pick	Outcome MPG	Tier
1	Tyler Zeller	2012	17	17.5	rotation
2	Rakeem Christmas	2015	36	7.5	bust
3	Andrew Nicholson	2012	19	14.3	bench
4	Jerome Jordan	2010	44	7.5	bust
5	Neemias Queta	2021	39	9.7	bench

Frame-based film observations (mine). No completed frame note was available for this prospect; the board does not infer film traits from missing frames.

10 Honorable Mentions

Rank	Prospect	Pos	Team/School	Model p50	Consensus
31	Zuby Ejiofor	PF	St. John's	16.9	30.7
32	Luigi Suigo	C	KK Mega Basket	17.1	30.3
33	Alex Karaban	SF/PF	UConn	16.5	31.5
34	Ryan Conwell	SG	Louisville	15.3	37.0
35	Baba Miller	SF	Cincinnati	14.2	37.0
36	Ja'kobi Gillespie			15.1	40.0
37	Richie Saunders	SG	BYU	15.7	38.7
38	Sergio de Larrea	PG/SG	Valencia	15.7	37.2
39	Trevon Brazile	PF	Arkansas	13.5	37.7
40	Jaden Bradley	PG	Arizona	15.0	39.2

11 Fit-Adjusted Mock Draft

This mock draft is a separate artifact from the big board. It starts from the actual pick owners, then chooses among high-ranked available prospects using a broad fit heuristic. Fit can break ties, but it should not justify passing on a materially better talent tier.

Pick	Owner	Selection	Board	Pos	Need fit	Alternatives
1	Washington	AJ Dybantsa	1	SF	primary creator; wing scoring; defensive identity	Darryn Peterson; Cameron Boozer; Keaton Wagler
2	Utah	Darryn Peterson	2	SG/PG	on-ball creation; lead guard; two-way wings	Cameron Boozer; Keaton Wagler; Caleb Wilson
3	Memphis	Caleb Wilson	5	SF/PF	frontcourt skill; wing size; half-court offense	Cameron Boozer; Keaton Wagler; Kingston Flemings
4	Chicago	Cameron Boozer	3	PF	top-end talent; creator; frontcourt anchor	Keaton Wagler; Kingston Flemings; Darius Acuff Jr.
5	LA Clippers	Keaton Wagler	4	SG/PG	young creator; athleticism; long-term star equity	Kingston Flemings; Darius Acuff Jr.; Mikel Brown Jr.
6	Brooklyn	Yaxel Lendeborg	12	PF	creation; frontcourt upside; shooting	Kingston Flemings; Darius Acuff Jr.; Mikel Brown Jr.
7	Sacramento	Dailyn Swain	16	SG/SF	lead guard depth; point-of-attack defense; wing size	Kingston Flemings; Darius Acuff Jr.; Mikel Brown Jr.
8	Atlanta	Nate Ament	11	SF	defensive forward; secondary playmaking; rim pressure	Kingston Flemings; Darius Acuff Jr.; Mikel Brown Jr.
9	Dallas	Kingston Flemings	6	PG	two-way wing; guard depth; future upside	Darius Acuff Jr.; Mikel Brown Jr.; Brayden Burries
10	Milwaukee	Darius Acuff Jr.	7	PG	youth; shot creation; frontcourt depth	Mikel Brown Jr.; Brayden Burries; Labaron Philon Jr.
11	Golden State	Brayden Burries	9	SG/PG	NBA-ready guard/wing; shooting; defensive versatility	Mikel Brown Jr.; Labaron Philon Jr.; Aday Mara
12	Oklahoma City	Karim López	14	SF	luxury upside swing; size; stash flexibility	Mikel Brown Jr.; Labaron Philon Jr.; Aday Mara
13	Miami	Labaron Philon Jr.	10	PG	shot creation; forward size; shooting	Mikel Brown Jr.; Aday Mara; Cameron Carr

Pick	Owner	Selection	Board	Pos	Need fit	Alternatives
14	Charlotte	Aday Mara	13	C	defensive big; connective forward; shooting	Mikel Brown Jr.; Cameron Carr; Hannes Steinbach
15	Chicago	Mikel Brown Jr.	8	PG	top-end talent; creator; frontcourt anchor	Cameron Carr; Hannes Steinbach; Bennett Stirtz
16	Memphis	Hannes Steinbach	17	PF	frontcourt skill; wing size; half-court offense	Cameron Carr; Bennett Stirtz; Ebuka Okorie
17	Oklahoma City	Cameron Carr	15	SG	luxury upside swing; size; stash flexibility	Bennett Stirtz; Ebuka Okorie; Morez Johnson Jr.
18	Charlotte	Morez Johnson Jr.	20	PF	defensive big; connective forward; shooting	Bennett Stirtz; Ebuka Okorie; Allen Graves
19	Toronto	Bennett Stirtz	18	PG	guard creation; shooting; rim protection	Ebuka Okorie; Allen Graves; Christian Anderson
20	San Antonio	Allen Graves	21	PF	shooting; complementary defense; bench creation	Ebuka Okorie; Christian Anderson; Chris Cenac Jr.
21	Detroit	Christian Anderson	22	PG	floor spacing; defensive forward; backup creation	Ebuka Okorie; Chris Cenac Jr.; Koa Peat
22	Philadelphia	Joshua Jefferson	28	PF/SF	two-way wing; frontcourt depth; guard stability	Ebuka Okorie; Chris Cenac Jr.; Koa Peat
23	Atlanta	Chris Cenac Jr.	23	PF/C	defensive forward; secondary playmaking; rim pressure	Ebuka Okorie; Koa Peat; Meleek Thomas
24	New York	Henri Veesaar	26	C	cost-controlled depth; shooting; defensive versatility	Ebuka Okorie; Koa Peat; Meleek Thomas
25	Los Angeles Lakers	Alex Karaban	33	SF/PF	guard creation; athletic wing; frontcourt depth	Ebuka Okorie; Koa Peat; Meleek Thomas
26	Denver	Tarris Reed Jr.	30	C	bench creation; shooting; athletic defense	Ebuka Okorie; Koa Peat; Meleek Thomas
27	Boston	Ebuka Okorie	19	PG	cost-controlled wing; guard depth; shooting	Koa Peat; Meleek Thomas; Jayden Quaintance
28	Minnesota	Zuby Ejiofor	31	PF	guard depth; shooting; frontcourt insurance	Koa Peat; Meleek Thomas; Jayden Quaintance
29	Cleveland	Isaiah Evans	29	SF	wing size; shooting; bench creation	Koa Peat; Meleek Thomas; Jayden Quaintance
30	Dallas	Meleek Thomas	25	SG/PG	two-way wing; guard depth; future upside	Koa Peat; Jayden Quaintance; Luigi Suigo

12 Discussion

The top of the class is strong but not perfectly separated. AJ Dybantsa, Darryn Peterson, and Cameron Boozer are the safest star-bet tier because consensus, model value, age, and comps all point in the same direction. Keaton Wagler is the highest meaningful model-over-market riser: his statistical profile and bootstrapped model value push him into the same quantitative band as the consensus top three. Caleb Wilson and Kingston Flemings round out the next tier because the model likes their production/age context while the consensus still leaves room for interpretation.

The largest disagreements are more instructive than the exact order. Prospects with older age, thin shooting samples, incomplete combine data, or high public spread are intentionally pushed down unless the model and comps provide a strong counterweight. Conversely, several guards with strong creation indicators rise because assist production and market rank show up as meaningful predictors in historical validation.

13 Limitations and Threats to Validity

- Official NBA stats combine endpoints timed out from this environment; hand size, body fat, some height-with-shoes fields, and official drill completeness are therefore incomplete.
- Basketball Reference pages were blocked for bulk direct fetches, so the primary historical target is NBA MPG-equivalent rather than a fully refreshed VORP or win-shares target.
- International and alternative-pathway statistics are not perfectly comparable with NCAA BPM, usage, and per-40 rates. Median imputation avoids crashes but cannot create missing information.
- The film study is still-frame sampled. It supports static posture/mechanics observations only and should not be read as full live scouting.
- Team context uses broad roster/timeline inference. It is not a cap-sheet optimizer and does not model private workouts, medicals, or trade conversations.
- The public consensus is itself partly endogenous with team intel and scouting reputation. The model can validate or challenge the market, but it cannot fully disentangle why the market ranked a player where it did.

14 Reproducibility

The reproducible pipeline lives in `src/`. To rerun the project from the repository root, execute the following scripts in order. Network-dependent fetch steps may change if sites modify markup or access rules.

```
python3 src/fetch_live_data.py
python3 src/fetch_historical_data.py
python3 src/fetch_additional_sources.py
python3 src/build_live_datasets.py
python3 src/build_historical_dataset.py
python3 src/run_modeling_and_comps.py
python3 src/import_film_archive.py
python3 src/generate_report.py
python3 src/generate_latex_report.py
```

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16 Appendix: Data Dictionary

Artifact	Purpose
data/processed/prospects_2026.csv	Cleaned 2026 prospect table with consensus, measurements, and production.
data/processed/prospect_model_scores_2026.csv	2026 model predictions, probabilities, board score, tiers, and comps summary.
data/processed/historical.csv	Historical pre-draft features and NBA MPG-equivalent outcomes for modeling.
data/processed/historical_comps_2026.csv	Five nearest historical statistical comps for every 2026 prospect.
models/metrics.json	Leave-one-draft-class-out regression metrics and tier-classifier matrix.
models/feature_importance.csv	Permutation importance from the final gradient boosting model.
film/notes/	Per-prospect film notes separating frame observations from sourced human scouting.
figures/	Generated charts and shareable graphics used in the report.